

NGA Enterprise Engineering (NEE) Foundation GEOINT Mission Planning

As-Is Process Model Suite: Foundation GEOINT (FG) Information Technology (IT) Governance Processes

Foundation GEOINT Technology Division (SFCA)

Version 1.0

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The Overall Classification of this document is **UNCLASSIFIED**

Table of Contents

BACKGROUND	3
RECORD OF CHANGES.....	4
FOUNDATION GEOINT (FG) INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY (IT) GOVERNANCE PROCESS AS-IS OVERVIEW MODEL.....	5
INTRODUCTION	5
ASSUMPTIONS	5
FG IT GOVERNANCE AS-IS OVERVIEW MODEL.....	6
FG CAPABILITY ASSESSMENT PREPARATION SUB-PROCESS AS-IS PROCESS MODEL	19
FG CAPABILITY ASSESSMENT PREPARATION INTRODUCTION	19
FG CAPABILITY ASSESSMENT PREPARATION SUB-PROCESS MODEL	20
SF MISSION ASSESSMENT SUB-PROCESS AS-IS PROCESS MODEL.....	31
SF MISSION ASSESSMENT INTRODUCTION.....	31
SF MISSION ASSESSMENT SUB-PROCESS MODEL.....	31
APPENDIX A: FG CAPABILITY ASSESSMENT PREPARATION SUB-PROCESS NUMBERED MODEL AND DEFINITIONS.....	39
FG CAPABILITY ASSESSMENT PREPARATION SUB-PROCESS MODEL DEFINITIONS	39
APPENDIX B: FG CAPABILITY ASSESSMENT PREPARATION SUB-PROCESS AS-IS TABLE VIEW	44
APPENDIX C: SF MISSION ASSESSMENT SUB-PROCESS NUMBERED MODEL AND DEFINITIONS	49
SF MISSION ASSESSMENT SUB-PROCESS MODEL DEFINITIONS.....	49
APPENDIX D: SF MISSION ASSESSMENT SUB-PROCESS AS-IS TABLE VIEW	52
APPENDIX E: ‘HAPPY PATH’ OVERVIEW MODEL VIEW	55
OVERVIEW MODEL – “HAPPY PATH” VIEW	55
APPENDIX F: BPMN 2.0 LEGEND	56
APPENDIX G: GLOSSARY	57
APPENDIX H: ACRONYM LIST.....	59
APPENDIX I: FG IT GOVERNANCE AS-IS PROCESS SOCIALIZATION	60
INPUTS FROM RESEARCH GROUP AND SFN ENGAGEMENTS – SPRING 2024.....	60

Background

NGA's Foundation GEOINT Group (SF) and the Mapping, Charting & Geodesy (MC&G) Program Management Office (PMO)¹ have been working together since 2021 to continuously evolve an effective Foundation GEOINT (FG) Information Technology (IT) governance model. The goal of IT governance is to enable better informed and more transparent IT investment decisions across both organizations and ensure compliance with SF-level standards for IT development and maintenance.

The need for IT governance exists because; 1) SF has historically decentralized IT investment decision making at the Office level; 2) CIO-T has executed a separate, FG IT budget to support development as well as operations and maintenance for SF mission requirements; and 3) Coordination between SF and MC&G budgets is imperative to maximize spending efficiency and ensure execution of high-priority requirements. IT investment decisions occurring at the SF Office level rather than the Group level, while seemingly more expeditious, have resulted in multiple issues such as an unnecessary growth in IT contracts that often results in costly integration and sustainment challenges, sometimes years after initial contract award; stand-alone IT that is not properly maintained and is not always part of the GEOINT Enterprise Architecture (GEA) or the configuration management baseline.

SF must improve on this legacy IT governance model and can do so by leveraging a centralized governance framework that ensures all FG IT is procured, developed and maintained effectively through the MC&G PMO. This governance framework consists of the Foundation GEOINT Information Technology Requirements Board (FIRB) managed at the SF Group-level, the MC&G PMO Technical Review Board (TRB), and the MC&G PMO Risk and Opportunities Management Board (ROMB).

There are three key factors, which will determine the effectiveness of FG IT governance: 1) Established standards that communicate how FG IT will be governed by positioning the FIRB as the "Front Door" for all FG IT requirements in SF; 2) the coordination and collaboration between the FIRB, TRB, and the ROMB; and 3) the future process established and coordination between the SF IT Governance and Transition Mission Manager and the Capability Mission Manager.

This artifact provides the existing processes and captures Pain Points and To-Be Notes to support the future evolution of the FG IT Governance process. Further, the artifact contains a description of two of the sub-processes that comprise the FIRB-focused sections of the governance process. Finally, this artifact documents Pain Points in the current process, as well as topics for further investigation to evolve the process (To-Be Notes), collected from governance stakeholders, to include the SF IT Governance Team, NGA Research, SF Production Office Technical Executives (TXs), and the MC&G PMO.

¹ Formerly known as the Integrated Program Office - Foundation GEOINT (IPF)

Record of Changes

Version	Date	Description	Author	Approver
1.0	8 Nov 2024	SF IT Governance Processes Summary	NEE TO14 – FGMP	Jordan Gibb, SFCA, SF IT Governance Mission Manager

Foundation GEOINT (FG) Information Technology (IT) Governance Process As-Is Overview Model

Introduction

This Overview Model illustrates the high-level, end-to-end process from IT need or capability identification to disposition and provides the framework for the overarching FG IT Governance process. Development of this artifact was driven by the Foundation GEOINT Group Corporate Operations and Technology Office (SFC) desire to formally document the existing business processes governing the assessment and implementation of IT capabilities in support of Source Foundation GEOINT Group (SF) mission. This technology-agnostic process is expected to facilitate socialization with stakeholders associated with the Foundation GEOINT Information Technology Requirements Board (FIRB). The overarching goal of this process is to realize improved, more transparent IT capability-related activities, which include prioritization, funding, and acquisition of capabilities to effectively support the ever-evolving SF Mission.

The FIRB, the TRB and the ROMB comprise a three-board governance framework. The FIRB, run by SFC, is positioned as the “front door” for all FG IT requirements and serves two primary purposes: 1) Vetting new and emerging IT capabilities and validating mission requirements via proposals to all SF Technical Executives and other leadership stakeholders across the organization during a public forum; and 2) Facilitating the prioritization of IT requirements by the MC&G Mission Owner (MO) to allow for optimal application of engineering and program management resources. The TRB, run by the MC&G PMO, is essentially the implementation arm of the process, providing engineering, integration, and transition support to validate the feasibility of IT capabilities to satisfy SF-validated requirements and develop implementation solutions. The ROMB, run by the MC&G PMO, is responsible for tracking and managing related risks and opportunities; however, it is not currently fully integrated into the FG IT Governance Process.

This artifact clarifies the As-Is FG IT governance process and identifies opportunities for improvement, using input garnered from key stakeholders. An initial round of engagements with FG IT Governance stakeholders was completed in 2024. Results of these engagements can be found throughout this document as Pain Points and To-Be Notes, both in the process models sections and the Appendices (see Appendix I).

Assumptions

1. The FIRB is a mission-focused governance board for SF; therefore, all capability introductions and assessments must have an SF Technical Executive (TX) sponsor for submission to the FG IT Governance Process.
2. The FIRB is the ‘front door’ for capability enhancements, new capability requests, and any other FG IT requirements requiring resources for SF production offices.
 - a. The TRB conducts capability transition assessments and engineering analyses of alternatives (AoAs) for capabilities that have been vetted by the FIRB.
 - b. TRB assessments of acquisition packages do not require FIRB review, though they do require execution of their own approval process and may be brought to the FIRB for informational purposes, if desired.
 - c. SF TXs and their designated SMEs attend the FIRB. Since the goal of the FIRB is to gather input on pre-vetted capabilities, regular FIRB attendance by these SF subject matter experts (SMEs) is essential.
3. MC&G PMO representatives are not required to attend the FIRB. They are also not intended to engage in a mission-centric discussion at the FIRB; however, their attendance is encouraged as it allows them to hear business cases and SF responses from the FG SMEs and keep potentially impacted MC&G PMO projects properly informed.

8 November 2024

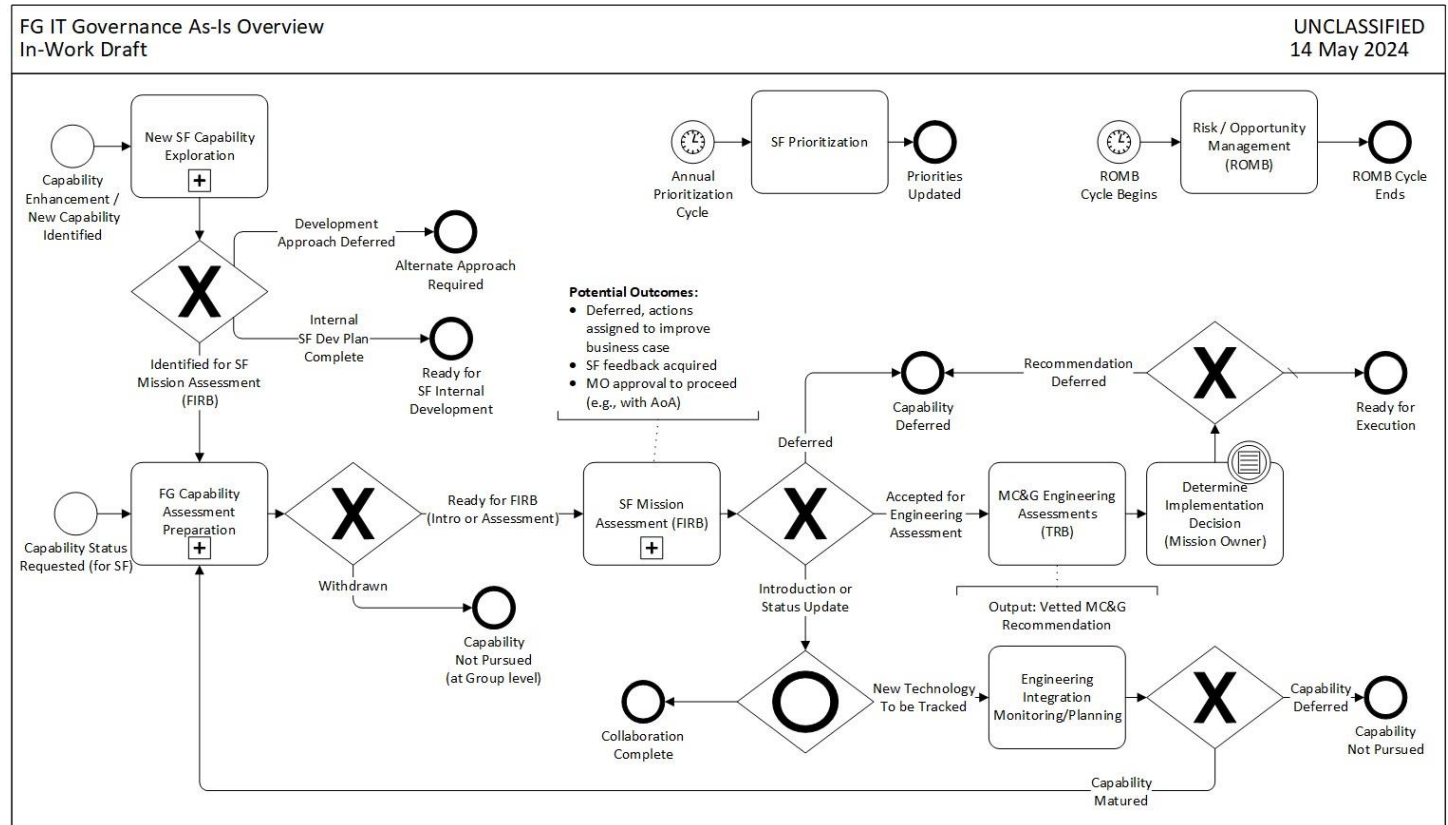
Foundation GEOINT Technology Division

FG Mission Planning [Final]

As-Is Process Models

4. From a governance process perspective, the process ends once a request (e.g., for a new capability, an enhancement, etc.) has been approved through the SF Mission Assessment process (FIRB), the MC&G Engineering Assessment Process (via the TRB) is completed, and the recommendation is validated for implementation by the MC&G Mission Owner. See the definition of FG IT Governance in the Glossary (Appendix F).
5. Mission Owner decisions are made based on a series of guiding principles² as well as the SF Priorities (e.g., 1-to-n list) to ensure optimal support to FG Mission needs.

FG IT Governance As-Is Overview Model



FG IT Governance As-Is Overview Description

This Overview model provides a high-level visual representation of the FG IT Governance As-Is process, including the identification, assessment, and prioritization of IT capabilities supporting the FG mission. The process is characterized by two potential paths: the most common path beginning with the identification of a new need for an IT capability enhancement or a new capability, generally by an SF production office. The governance process can also begin when a status update has been requested for a capability which already has full SF support via the FIRB. The activities within the Overview model illustrate the key components of the governance process. This includes how SF identifies and explores potential IT needs, how capabilities are prepared for SF assessment at the FIRB, and how the FIRB facilitates assessment

² Guiding Principles are not yet a formalized artifact and may change over time as goals are accomplished and new focus areas are defined. Currently these include integration of processes and data across FG domains, maximizing the use of FG enterprise solutions, improved data-centricity, addressing fiscal efficiency (i.e., “do more with less”) and enabling modernization leading to Foundation Digital Twin (FDT). See To-Be Note #1 in the SF Mission Assessment Sub-Process section of this document for the recommendation to formally document these principles.

8 November 2024

Foundation GEOINT Technology Division

FG Mission Planning [Final]

As-Is Process Models

and socialization of SF-related capabilities, leveraging SF expertise to assist in informing IT decisions made by the MC&G Mission Owner. The process also describes how the engineering teams supporting the MC&G PMO provide technical evaluations and engineering expertise to assist in capability implementation planning and monitoring, and documents the existence of the SF Prioritization processes, and the need to evolve it to integrate with the rest of the governance framework more deliberately in the future. The overall process is complete when the capability has successfully been socialized, assessed, and approved for implementation, or when it has been deferred by any of the decision-makers during execution of the process (e.g., SF Office TX/sponsor, MC&G Mission Owner). Each of the tasks and sub-processes are further summarized below.

New SF Capability Exploration Sub-Process

This SF-centric sub-process depicts the coordination required to acquire office-level sponsorship (i.e., an SF Production Office TX) of a potential IT capability, work with the development organization to complete initial coordination activities and determine whether the capability should proceed further in the overall FG IT governance process. The primary trigger that initiates this sub-process is the identification of a new capability or existing capability enhancement to benefit the SF mission. Development of a new capability identified at this stage may be via Research, DevCorps, or SF, and will generally undergo SF Mission Assessment at the FIRB, either as an introduction briefing (informational only) or for a formal capability assessment, if funding and/or other engineering activities are required from the MC&G PMO. Internally developed solutions are not required to execute the SF Mission Assessment Sub-Process (i.e., go to the FIRB) unless funding and/or sustainment are required. Any capabilities approved to move forward will proceed to the FG Capability Assessment Preparation Sub-Process, where the SF IT Governance Team will assist in managing the development of the appropriate SF Mission Assessment artifacts (e.g., Capability Introduction briefings, Business Cases, etc.) prior to appearing at the FIRB.

FG Capability Assessment Preparation Sub-Process

After SF has identified a TX sponsor and it is ready to move forward in the process, they begin to prepare the capability / need for presentation to the MC&G MO and SF stakeholders at the FIRB. This presentation may be for a formal decision (e.g., request for a transition assessment, engineering analysis, or implementation approval) or for collaboration (e.g., FIRB introduction, status update). The SF IT Governance Team will work with the requestor to assign a FIRB date and ensure that the Business Case is complete, to include the specific type of engineering assessment being requested, if applicable. If the SF IT Governance Team determines that the Business Case is not ready for presentation, they will work with the requestor to reschedule a future FIRB date. The Business Case must be completed and approved by the SF IT Governance Team at least 7 days prior to the scheduled board meeting.

In addition to the primary flow described above, this sub-process will also be used to prepare a capability to return to the FIRB at appropriate times in the engineering lifecycle. This is often needed to socialize progress and solicit SF input for the MO to determine the next steps. In these cases, the requestor will work with the SF IT Governance Team to develop an updated business case. See expanded sub-process below for additional details.

SF Mission Assessment (FIRB) Sub-Process

This sub-process details the steps to execute a FIRB session, to include presenting the business case, stakeholder review and comments, and documentation of any outcomes or decisions made during the meeting. On the scheduled date, the FIRB, led by the SF Mission Owner and SF IT Governance Team, convenes. The SF requestor and/or SF TX sponsor presents the business case to the forum. SF representatives are encouraged to ask questions and provide input that may

8 November 2024

Foundation GEOINT Technology Division

FG Mission Planning [Final]

As-Is Process Models

assist the Mission Owner in making any required decisions on whether to advance the capability further. The MO and SF IT Governance Team encourage participation from the SF TXs to foster collaboration and build consensus on the path forward. A business case is either approved or deferred by the MC&G MO at the FIRB. When approved, the capability proposed will be forwarded to the MC&G TRB for assignment to an engineer. The MC&G PMO engineering lead will perform the appropriate engineering activities [e.g., analysis of alternatives (AoA) or a transition assessment (see MC&G Engineering Assessments sub-process)³]. If a request is missing vital information, does not align in terms of timing, or is not deemed to be a high enough priority, it may be deferred for future consideration and may persist on the FIRB backlog indefinitely. See expanded sub-process below for additional details. If the briefing was a Capability Introduction, the FIRB may determine that the capability should be monitored and that the MC&G PMO should begin planning for eventual transition into operations (see Engineering Integration Monitoring/Planning Sub-Process)⁴.

MC&G Engineering Assessments (TRB) Sub-Process⁵

Once a capability or capability need has been reviewed by SF and approved by the MC&G Mission Owner for further study, this sub-process begins an engineering assessment by the MC&G PMO. The FG-related engineering efforts are overseen by the MC&G PMO engineers via the Technical Review Board (TRB), led by the MC&G Deputy Program Director. Once the required artifacts have been received, the MC&G PMO will board the request at the TRB to further understand the capability brief. The MO has already decided on whether to conduct an Engineering Analysis of Alternatives (AoA) or a Transition Assessment. The decision of which of these two types of TRB-directed assessment options is based on the level of maturity of the capability and how much information is known. The presentation provided to the TRB helps to inform the MC&G PMO and other stakeholders of the action required and way forward. After the assessment is completed (typically 30-90 days), the TRB reviews and approves a recommendation, and it is provided to the MC&G Mission Owner for a final decision.

Engineering Integration Monitoring/Planning Sub-Process

This sub-process captures what is required to monitor and plan for potential new capabilities that the FIRB has committed to track through transition into operations or sustainment under the purview of the MC&G PMO. Today, these capabilities are almost always new Research technologies. The MC&G PMO Transition Lead will identify a PM to be responsible for monitoring and planning for eventual integration of this capability. The PM works with the development team to generate estimates for the eventual O&S costs and identifies the integration tasks that are required to transition the capability. Once the development team is ready to transition the capability to O&S, they seek approval from the appropriate SF Product Owner (PdO) and the SF Office TX. Once their approval is secured, the SF sponsor will update the business case and seek final approval from the MC&G Mission Owner (see Determine Implementation Decision).

Determine Implementation Decision (Mission Owner)

In addition to serving as the decision authority for SF Mission Assessments (i.e., FIRB requests), the MC&G Mission Owner is also the decision authority for FG IT capabilities based on the outcomes of MC&G Engineering Assessments

³ Technical recommendations developed by the TRB may come back to the FIRB for discussion, but this full process cycle has not yet been executed on in its entirety.

⁴ Many of these capability introductions may be Research capabilities which will require a Research Technology Transition Agreement (TTA). Further discussion is required between SF and Research to finalize the policy and processes for how TTAs are handled, see To-Be Notes for more detail.

⁵ See the TRB Charter for a full description of this sub-process.

8 November 2024

Foundation GEOINT Technology Division

FG Mission Planning [Final]

As-Is Process Models

(i.e., TRB recommendations). New capabilities that are ready for incorporation into the MC&G PMO operational baseline and have gone through the appropriate governance steps are ready for a Mission Owner implementation decision (e.g., approval of TRB Engineering Assessment recommendation or deferral). This presentation is known as the Acceptance Briefing. The Mission Owner decision is made primarily based on the assessed readiness of the capability, SF priorities, and available funding. Technical trades or reprioritization of MC&G PMO activities and/or funding may be required to implement the recommended solution.

SF Prioritization

Twice a year SF reviews and updates the IT priorities for the entire FG Group. In May, the annual process begins and an initial “1-to-N” list of priorities, as well as priority groups (i.e., bins) are created. The MC&G Mission Owner provides the initial list to all of SF to solicit feedback and recommendations. The priorities are updated and presented to the SF Director for final prioritization and approval. In October, the MC&G MO leads an effort to review and update the priorities, with the SF Offices and then with the SF Director again as the final decision authority. These priorities directly influence the FY spend plan, the FG IT Roadmap, and MC&G PMO engineering efforts. They are actively used in this process by the MC&G MO to make implementation decisions, both at the FIRB, and after receiving TRB engineering recommendations.

Risk/Opportunities Management Board (ROMB)

The ROMB is a board chaired by the MC&G PMO Deputy Director that systematically identifies, assesses, and manages risks and opportunities related to the management and execution of MC&G IT entities. It provides guidance on establishing proactive measures to mitigate potential threats, addressing current challenges, and exploiting opportunities to enhance program success. The ROMB is not fully integrated with the FG IT Governance process and is mentioned due to its overarching role concerning risks and opportunities.

Pain Points

Overarching Topics

1. The current FG IT Governance process is not focused on requirements. Instead, it is focused on implementation and sustainment of existing IT capabilities, without a trace back to the Foundation GEOINT products that they support. The MC&G PMO is currently structured based on IT contracts and tracks via systems, whereas the production offices are data/product focused. The MC&G PMO has recently announced a restructure; however, without careful consideration of the alignment with the requirements process and an effective governance process, it may continue to be largely ineffective in terms of supporting FG production. See related To-Be Notes #7, #25, and #31.
2. The current governance process reflects a mixture of the new Scaled Agile Framework (SAFe) and the traditional “Systems Engineering V” Model. The role of the architecture team, as well as when and where cost and integration planning take place within the process is not well defined. With this combination of methodologies there are major gaps in the planning for and tracking/accountability of both requirements and IT capabilities. See related To-Be Note #9, # 26, and #29.
3. The level of effort to bring a capability through the process, particularly in regards to the transition of IT capabilities from the Aeronautical Navigation Office (SFA) to the MC&G PMO, can be challenging and difficult to navigate. SFA has always managed its own requirements and has historically been successful. The future FG IT

8 November 2024

Foundation GEOINT Technology Division

FG Mission Planning [Final]

As-Is Process Models

Governance process must not introduce overly cumbersome hurdles for SF, who would like to streamline this process of transitioning capabilities without impacts to operations. See related To-Be Note #8 and #19.

4. SF needs a process for funding, implementation, and management of smaller tools (bigger tools we can go through Research, etc.), as procuring these tools within the SF organization is not permitted. It is important to take into account the fact that there is no clear process for how SF engages the NGA Commercial Operations Group (SC) for a commercial capability. Currently the offices are responsible for figuring out how to address these smaller tools/capabilities on their own, making this much more challenging than it would be if a standard process existed. See related To-Be Notes #5 and #6.

SF Prioritization

5. There is not a formal connection between the official SF prioritization process and the FG IT Governance process. Development of SF priorities occurs too late for Research to plan for and allocate funding and is not always coordinated with other priority inputs (e.g., 'hard problems' lists), which prevents Research from effectively planning for the development of new capabilities to meet high-priority SF requirements. See related To-Be Notes #14, #15.
6. There are multiple issues associated with how and by whom the capability prioritization process is executed today. Some of the concern is simply lack of awareness around how decisions are made with respect to each office's top priorities. A single source for SF priorities is needed in order to consistently make appropriate decisions on which FG IT capability needs should be explored, funded, and developed. Without a streamlined, well-socialized prioritization process, frustration with unexpected funding decisions will continue, and SF Offices will be more limited in their ability to plan alternatives or mitigation strategies for capabilities falling below the line for development and funding by the MC&G PMO. See related To-Be Note #16.
7. Research does not have clear guidance from SF on the IT capability needs that would help them meet their high-priority requirements. Additionally, the drivers [i.e., priorities, hard problems lists, Statement of Capabilities (SOC)/ Intelligence Capability Baseline Description (ICBD)] are not clearly aligned across different efforts, adding complexity to the process of determining which IT capabilities are the true high value needs that should be focus areas for development. Currently, Research performs a significant amount of outreach and research to solicit needs and evaluate the potential for successful integration into the operational baseline, but these needs should ideally be flowed to Research from mission areas (e.g., SF) in a more uniform, consistent manner. Recently Research has been focused on the GEOINT hard problems, which were developed but not widely disseminated by NGA leadership. They also received a set of Geodesy hard problems during a meeting with the Office of Geomatics (SFN); however, they do not align with the GEOINT hard problems, and it was unknown how they align with SFN and/or SF priorities. In addition, the SOC/ICBD effort provides a large amount of information on capability needs; however, potential solutions are not always clearly defined; alignment with SF priorities is sometimes lacking, and there is no alignment with the GEOINT hard problems. Without an integrated and complete set of priorities to guide Research, potential opportunities to achieve efficiency are missed. See related To-Be Notes #16 and #17.

Engineering Integration Monitoring/Planning

8. There is currently a lack of transparency or visibility associated with the process to secure funds to transition a capability to sustainment; in particular, the origin of the funds and whether they will in fact be secured at a later

date, if applicable. Moreover, once a capability is approved by the engineering team, the cost estimate may go to the SF Production Office, but there are no further updates regarding the commitment of funds. There is also confusion regarding what happens to a capability if MC&G has to prioritize a new capability over something already in work. This lack of clarity often leads to confusion and delays in transitioning a capability to operations and/or sustainment. The process to secure funds to transition a capability to sustainment, to include next steps when an attempt to secure funding hits a wall, needs to be more clearly defined and communicated. Without more clarity and transparency in the acquisition of transition funding, there is continued risk for capability delays or failure to implement capabilities altogether. These issues also negatively impact buy-in for the FG IT Governance processes and introduce uncertainty to resource and program planning. See related To-Be Note #21.

MC&G Engineering Assessments / PMO

9. MC&G's program build does not include Research and Development (R&D) planned transitions and hasn't for the last several years. None of R&D's FY26 transitions were included in MC&G's FY26 program build, even though components of the program build are aligned with FG strategic documents such as the Statement of Capabilities (SOC) and the Intelligence Capability Baseline Description (ICBD) and were brought to the FIRB by SF sponsors. Ideally, the future governance process should influence the program build and have contingencies in place regardless of the outcome of the program build to support transition of key capabilities. Utilization of the NGA/R Technology Transition Agreement (TTA) could be a piece of this future process. See related To-Be Note #32.
10. Currently there is not a trace between the systems and services the MC&G PMO manages and the products that are produced by the SF Production Offices. The Production Offices track mission success based on data and product coverage, while the PMO tracks by systems. Production of data and products is the core mission of the Production Office, and without a direct tie to those, the FG IT Governance process is at risk of being ineffective. MC&G struggles to manage duplicative efforts, because each Office tailors their architecture, solutions, software, contracts to their own requirements. Managing the trace between products and enabling systems/services will increase efficiencies that will reduce costs & duplications. See related To-Be Notes #27 and #28.
11. There are not enough engineers within the MC&G PMO to support all the engineering needs of the Production Offices. These engineers are critical to identifying a complete solution to the established requirements, putting together a cost estimate, and determining an integration plan for new capabilities in development. The engineers are often siloed by the mission execution phase (e.g., get it, make it, manage it, share it), which is not ideal for all engineering activities. The appropriate volume (and organizational structure) of MC&G PMO engineering support needs to align with the needs of SF or else critical engineering support will not be available to inform capability development. See related To-Be Note #23
12. Critical communication from the MC&G PMO related to software changes must be provided further in advance to minimize reactive activities to perform software fixes (i.e., Adobe, ArcMap to ArcPro transition, etc.). The lack of dependable, timely communication on software requirements leaves production offices at a disadvantage, often having to scramble at the last minute to implement changes and try to minimize impacts to the mission. See related To-Be Note #30.

13. The IT Portfolio is not currently well diversified. SF missions would be better served with more options of vendors and contractors. Additionally, it is a challenge to understand which capabilities are managed by MC&G, and which are not – transparency into this status (e.g., binning of all capabilities into appropriate categories) is lacking. See related To-Be Note #31.

To-Be Notes

Overarching Topics

1. The SF IT Governance Team should determine whether SF dissemination requirements are part of this governance process. Dissemination capabilities, executed primarily by the Source GEOINT Information Group (ST), have a critical role in ensuring that SF content is made available to the end users; however, these capabilities are broader than SF. If dissemination requirements become part of this process, rules should be established to determine when a capability should be assessed by SF at the FIRB, and whether it should come through the full assessment process or be presented as an informational briefing. The addition of a Dissemination Mission Owner and Dissemination Project to the MC&G PMO, and their relationship to this FG IT governance process, should also be addressed. Inclusion of dissemination requirements in the governance process would incorporate coordination and collaboration that does not exist today. The coordination would also contribute to transparency and visibility.
2. To help facilitate the discussions on the future of the Research Forum Working Group (RFGW), the SF IT Governance team should define the process functions accomplished by the RFGW, in order to capture those related to FG IT Governance (particularly those which are part of the Capability Exploration Sub-Process). The RFGW itself is not a governance body, but it is a forum that helps to inform/drive capability exploration and should therefore be better understood to ensure that the essential functions of the RFGW required as interactions with the governance process are properly captured.
3. The SF IT Governance team should draft and disseminate a list of the benefits of adhering to the FG IT Governance processes to increase support, advocacy, participation and enthusiasm across the stakeholders and leader groups, in response to GEOINT Mission Managers' and SGAs' desire to cultivate authority and championing of capabilities/efforts.
4. The SF IT Governance team should consider leveraging a use case (such as the Bathy self-service topic that recently came to the FIRB) to expand the FG IT Governance process for the future.
5. The SF IT Governance team should work with the SF Production offices to discuss how SF can best utilize the governance process to secure funding for, implement, and manage smaller tools and capabilities that generally would not be developed by Research. The current process may require changes, or potentially establishing a separate process thread to more effectively and rapidly address these smaller capabilities, which could include commercially available solutions (see related Pain Point #4).
6. The SF IT Governance team should consider working with the Office of Geography (SFG) to explore the development of a process for SFG to purchase, implement, and transition Commercial Off The Shelf (COTS) tools to meet capability needs that are not currently available nor in development elsewhere across the enterprise. Incorporating a process to address COTS capabilities, as well as working with SC to develop commercial

capabilities, would broaden the FG IT governance process to more explicitly include the commercial use case, and enable easier utilization of commercial development capabilities that meet cost and performance needs.

7. The SF IT Governance team should consider aligning its activities to enable the ability to trace back to the Foundation GEOINT products that they support, in order to more effectively support FG production.
8. The SF IT Governance team should schedule additional socialization activities to explore opportunities to collaborate on evolution of FG IT Governance process (e.g., schedule follow-up socialization discussions with production offices, discussions with MC&G PMO, and coordinating with additional stakeholders beyond TXs. These conversations should include ensuring that changes to process are well understood and no longer perceived of as cumbersome by the Production Offices).
9. The SF IT Governance team should work with the appropriate parties to further define the role of the architecture team and more clearly highlight cost and integration activities in the process. Furthermore, a discussion on how best to structure its approach as either SAFe or the traditional Systems Engineering V model is needed to address gaps in the planning for and tracking of requirements and IT capabilities.
10. Further discussion is desired between SF and Research to formalize the TTA process and establish its relationship to FG IT Governance. This will require finalization of both the policy and processes for how Technology Transition Agreements (TTAs) are handled.
 - a. Exploration of the TTA process, along with similar processes utilized by SF production offices, will be a valuable input to developing a more mature Capability Monitoring and Planning governance process. The team would like to work with Research to decompose the TTA process into functions to identify which components are valuable to the governance process in general, and to identify gaps in the as-is TTA process to be addressed by the To-Be process. As part of this exploration, the governance team would like to engage with the SF TXs to identify which, if any, processes they currently have within their offices to monitor and track potential capabilities in development, which could be integrated into the governance process, and evaluate which aspects of the TTA process could be replicated to monitor capabilities developed outside of Research. *Note: Recommendation from R is to start with EGM-TNG and Magneto, section 1 completed in Nov 2023.*
 - b. A codified TTA would enable the formal documentation of the TTA process, which would ensure standardization, consistency and rigor, which could enable the transition of more solutions into operations to enhance the SF mission. Ideally, either the TTA (or an agreed-upon alternative) will be codified via a formal NGA Instruction (NGAI) and included as part of this governance process. Key milestones in the TTA process could trigger appropriate governance processes to more consistently ensure that appropriate capabilities enter the governance process at the right time to properly support the socialization, development, and transition of these capabilities to the MC&G PMO. In lieu of an NGAI, an official agreement (i.e., SOP) could be written between SF and R to formally document the TTA process to ensure consistency.
11. The SF IT Governance Mission Manager and Research leadership should hold discussions to evaluate the cadence of the monthly Research Forum Working Group (RFGW) sessions and assess whether they should be held on a different cadence or on an ad-hoc basis. The relationship, communications, and processes between

Research, SF, and the MC&G PMO have matured significantly, potentially surpassing the need for recurring monthly Working Group sessions and Quarterly Forums. The Working Group sessions have fostered dynamic, ad-hoc engagements to occur as needed. Research PMRs are now open to all stakeholders for updates and tracking purposes; SF and the MC&G PMO receive updates on all Research programs projected to transition to the MC&G PMO. Continued, routine coordination between Research and SF through SFC should inform as to the best time and venue for a working group discussion to ensure efficient utilization of limited resources.

12. The SF IT Governance Team needs a better understanding of how individual FG Production offices across SF engage with Research and the MC&G PMO today, in order to gather more ideas and lessons learned on how to streamline this process, especially in regards to leveraging a trace between systems/services and FG products. The team should engage with production offices to identify this information to inform future updates to the FG IT Governance process. See related Pain Point #9.

SF Prioritization

13. Further discussion is required to develop the process to create, update, and socialize the FIRB Backlog. Backlog entries need to clearly reflect funded capabilities, potential funded capabilities, and capabilities that are below the funding cut line. Socializing an updated FIRB backlog that clearly reflects the funding status of desired capabilities will enable and enhance the prioritization process. At a minimum, it will provide clarity as to which capabilities should be considered for prioritization and support consistent understanding of the status of capabilities within the governance process.
14. In the near term, the SF IT Governance Team needs to identify, and make available, the official Foundation GEOINT Group priorities. Additional discussions must occur to ensure that the prioritization process is clear to the production offices. This will help ensure they can provide better input, know when to expect an approved list, be aware of any changes, and better understand how and why decisions are made during this governance process. Understanding the SF priorities and “hard problems” further in advance would enable Research to develop a more informed portfolio of planned activities to support SF needs and would help stakeholders involved in FG IT governance decisions to balance a variety of capability developments in terms of priority, size, and other variables (e.g., cost, complexity, and execution timelines).
15. The SF IT Governance Team should further develop the SF Prioritization process. Further definition of the SF prioritization process should include, at a minimum:
 - a. Identify the parties responsible for managing and approving the priorities list, as well as establish any required roles and processes that do not exist.
 - b. Incorporate more transparency, communication and coordination in the SF prioritization process, so that the production offices are aware of priority shifts and decisions. Earlier involvement of a broader set of SF stakeholders in the prioritization process would add transparency with respect to prioritization decisions.
 - c. Continue exploration of the role of the SF TX in the development of the SF prioritization framework, as well as the potential for groups (e.g., Research) to collaborate directly with MC&G MO to plan and prioritize specific activities.

- d. Define the essential connection(s) between the SF Prioritization process and the current FG IT Governance process to ensure that the relationship is clear and priorities are effectively utilized.

16. The SF Prioritization process (i.e., 1-n list) should consider incorporating the ability to identify which capabilities should be developed by Research, DevCorps, or even collaboratively between the two groups. This could be a step towards identifying intended allocation of capability development up front in the process and would incorporate additional transparency in process execution.

New SF Capability Exploration

17. When determining the earliest point in the FG IT Governance process to begin collecting information on a topic, SFC should consider utilizing the stages defined as part of the Research Forum Working Group. The descriptions of the stages on the wiki page detail the various steps for socializing and evaluating a potential capability for attention by the Research group. Currently, the majority of these stages are executed during the SF Capability Exploration Sub-Process, far earlier than the current governance teams get involved. This could be started as early as the SF Proposals within the SF Capability exploration Sub-Process. Leveraging these stages, which are currently captured on the RWG wiki page, may identify opportunities to optimize coordination with Research. See Related To-Be Note #12.

Engineering Integration Monitoring/Planning

18. The SF IT Governance Team should work closely with SMEs, particularly Research, on further expanding the Engineering Integration Monitoring / Planning Sub-Process. Research endorses the documentation of capability monitoring and planning as a part of the governance process, because it aims to ensure that capabilities return to the FIRB at the right time and help to keep progress moving forward. This work should include considering the possibility of identifying whether a capability should be monitored or not and by whom, as a FIRB outcome.
19. SF TXs should continue to work with the SF IT Governance Team to ensure that the process meets their needs and that the status of a request is tracked and communicated back to them as it progresses through the governance process. Since the current process requires improvement to meet SF needs, appropriate coordination on process changes is critical. This coordination will help SF production offices minimize the use of an internal path to develop new capabilities, in favor of working with the MC&G MO by way of the FG IT governance process. The SF IT Governance Team will define an approach to addressing this topic as the governance process evolves. Working within the FG IT governance process will avail the organization of all of the benefits anticipated by governance, which includes visibility, transparency, and follow through to track the status and disposition of topics once they have been presented to the FIRB and/or TRB. See Related To-Be Note #24.
20. The SF IT Governance Team should work with the MC&G MO and the MC&G PMO to assess the cost and benefits of assigning an MC&G Project Manager to monitor new capabilities that have been determined at the FIRB to have enough potential and support an SF priority. If the MC&G PMO is able to support this work, the specific monitoring duties and methodology need to be defined. For example, for Research capabilities, a TTA may be used, and the PM would be responsible for drafting sections two and three of this artifact as the capability proceeds through the process. This role would also include monitoring the maturity of the capability, engaging in transition planning in partnership with capability provider and briefing updates to required stakeholders (e.g., FIRB, Component Acquisition Executive (CAE), etc.). Research recommends that the PM

attend capability developer (i.e., Research, DevCorps) PMRs, and ensure that the capability developer is invited to MC&G, Program Executive Officer (PEO), CAE PMRs.

21. SFC would like to formalize the role of the SFC Liaison Officer (LO) in regard to the FG IT Governance process, to include their specific responsibilities in support of Capability Monitoring and Planning. These individuals, out of the Technology Integration Branch (SFCAA), act as facilitators between SF and their stakeholders in other groups (e.g., MC&G), in addition to their function as Product Owners for the Foundation Digital Twin (FDT) Pillars. In the future, as a greater number of capabilities are identified for monitoring by the governance team, the LOs could play a valuable role in the monitoring, collaboration, and communication required to successfully bring capabilities back into the governance process at the appropriate times. SF representatives are needed to track potential solutions in a future capability monitoring process, and an alternative must be identified if the LO is determined not to be the appropriate role for this function.
22. The SF IT Governance Team and the MC&G PMO engineering teams should collaborate to define a more transparent, comprehensive (i.e., end-to-end) solution for managing transition of capabilities to the MC&G PMO for integration and/or sustainment. It is currently a difficult undertaking to transition Research-developed capabilities from Research to the intended user base/office/mission area; refinement to the process to identify the specific parties accountable for each step in the process would enhance FG IT Governance as a whole.
23. The SF IT Governance Team should further analyze how to support the integration & engineering needs of the production offices, and specifically determine if this handoff is something that should be an official part of the governance process. The SF IT Governance Team should not have to manage engineering; however, the SF leadership team needs to identify the appropriate individual/role to perform this function. SF needs to ensure that the Production Offices have the engineering support they need for the funded high-priority capabilities to ensure that the proper engineering and integration tasks can be completed in a timely fashion.
24. Develop the process for SF IT Governance leadership (i.e., SF IT Governance Team) to track progress/status of a capability after a decision is made, and the capability moves to implementation. This information would be valuable as a status update for SF and would enable the appropriate audience (e.g., FIRB) to address significant developments that may come up during project execution. Tracking could likely be done in Jira and would allow the governance team to better anticipate when a capability will return to the Capability Assessment Preparation Sub-Process and subsequently, the SF Mission Assessment Sub-Process (i.e., FIRB). There is currently no formal means to track a capability end-to-end from initial identification to implementation, and this would ensure that appropriate topics remain “on the radar” until deemed complete. See Related To-Be Note #19.
 - a. Potential flow: The SF IT Governance Team will reach out periodically to determine whether there is enough movement to provide an update to SF. The process may vary depending on whether the project has recently reached a milestone.

MC&G Engineering Assessments / PMO

25. SF and the MC&G PMO should continue to consider the way the MC&G PMO is organized, and how that impacts the ability to execute against FG IT needs. The shift to PEOs may provide a good opportunity to re-evaluate having a single PM oversee each SF Production Office. The Production Offices produce a variety of data and products and have many complex processes and IT needs. It takes a significant amount of time to fully

understand each mission area, and this understanding directly contributes to the success of IT solutions to support the mission. The number of reviews and approvals by different leaders within the organization required for an IT solution to proceed to the sustainment phase should be minimized.

26. The MC&G PMO should continue to explore how the FG architecture can provide the most value to SF IT Governance. The architecture could provide a view of individual services and how they are integrated and utilized across SF to meet the mission. If MC&G PMs could focus more time to understand the Offices' future product transitions, then MC&G PMs could better align the Offices' requirements to MC&G's standard architectures & solutions.
27. The MC&G PMO should consider further defining the common architecture to capture individual services. If the architecture depicted more detailed information about these services, the PMO should consider what it would take to manage the IT baseline at the services level. MC&G may be able to provide more cost-efficient solutions by aligning to standard architectures and managing at the services level (e.g., via Solution Epics) rather than at the system level. FG mission diversity and variety of system architectures make bringing all of SF onto a common architecture at the system level incredibly complex.
28. The MC&G PMO should more clearly define the hierarchy for IT governance. This should include a direct traceability between the services and the FG data/products they support, which are defined in the Intelligence Mission Data (IMD) Plan. Using this information, Engineers will need to understand & try to align each Office's requirements (including schedules and budgets) to the MC&G architecture to more effectively develop capabilities using "common" services. This mapping will also facilitate more effective enterprise engineering and integration activities, and more easily identify opportunities for cost savings (e.g., if a product is retired, all associated services, such as dissemination services, could be scaled back or potentially retired as well). It would also facilitate decision-making when a product is sunset, since the related enterprise services could also be retired (or scaled differently). See related Pain Point #9, and #1.
29. The MC&G PMO should determine which type of systems engineering method should be utilized (e.g., SAFe, traditional Systems Engineering V, etc.); communicate that clearly to all stakeholders; and identify the changes to the FG IT Governance process required to support it. This will help all parties better understand their roles in developing and implementing a capability. For example, MG&G PMO engineers need to understand the engineering and architecture efforts required to assist a production office.
30. The SF IT Governance Team should evaluate the current process for identifying and communicating software changes that impact SF (e.g., upgrade to ArcGIS Pro), and establish a solution to notify SF at an earlier date of any changes, in order to avoid last-minute scrambles to meet these software requirements. A means for consistent, clear communication of software baseline changes (e.g., a calendar of target dates for each change) should be considered. Improvements in this area would render a better outcome for SF and reduce lost time or potential impacts to mission based on addressing these software changes as 'quick turn', urgent activities. See related Pain Point #12.
31. The SF IT Governance Team and the MC&G PMO should hold further discussions with the FG Production Offices to identify whether the recent re-org, which intended to better consolidate each mission set (i.e., Air, Land, etc.) and clearly document which entity is managing each capability within their IT Portfolio. Ideally, these updates to

the org should contribute to better communication of responsibility for different capabilities and facilitate elevation of areas where the portfolio needs diversification to provide more options to the Production Offices to meet their needs. See related Pain Point #4.

32. The SF IT Governance Team should work with Research to discuss the process for including entities in the MC&G program build and explore how the governance process could be adjusted to better account for transition of Research programs. Specifically, clarifying why these programs were omitted from the FY26 program build would be helpful. Additionally, Research would like to collaborate on ideas to utilize the FG IT Governance process to reduce risk regarding the outcome of the program build process, either by influencing the program build itself, or by establishing mitigation plans to address programs that are omitted.

FG Capability Assessment Preparation Sub-Process As-Is Process Model

FG Capability Assessment Preparation Introduction

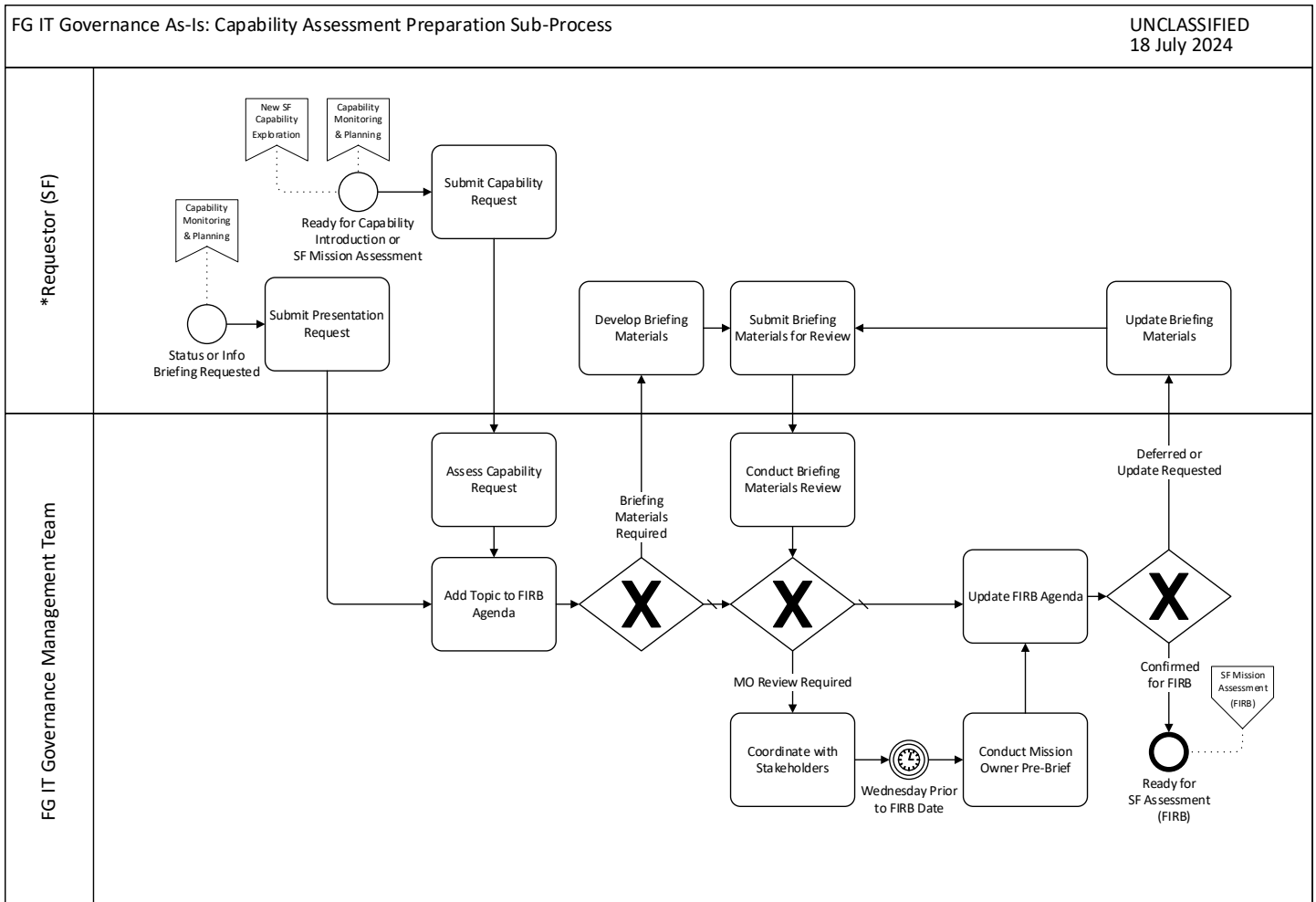
The FG Capability Assessment Preparation Sub-Process describes the steps required to arrange SF evaluation of a capability at the Foundation GEOINT Information Technology Requirements Board (FIRB), to include ensuring that all required materials (e.g., Capability Introduction Briefing, Business Case, etc.) are complete and ready for presentation to SF stakeholders. This sub-process initiates once SF has determined that a new proposed capability is ready to move forward in the process. The primary input to this sub-process is the submission of a Business Case, or other request to bring a topic to the FIRB. After receiving the submission, the SF IT Governance Team collaborates with the capability requestor to prepare the capability / need for presentation to the MC&G MO and SF stakeholders at the FIRB. This presentation may be for the purpose of obtaining a formal decision (e.g., request for a transition assessment, engineering analysis, or implementation approval) or for the goal of achieving enhanced awareness and transparency across the organization at appropriate times during the engineering life cycle (e.g., information or status briefing). The SF IT Governance Team will work with the requestor to assign a FIRB date and ensure that the briefing materials (e.g., Business Case, Capability Introduction briefing) are complete. If the SF IT Governance Team determines that the topic is not ready for presentation, they will work with the requestor to reschedule the topic for a future FIRB date. FG

8 November 2024

FG Mission Planning [Final]

Foundation GEOINT Technology Division

As-Is Process Models

FG Capability Assessment Preparation Sub-Process Model**FG Capability Assessment Preparation Sub-Process Model Definitions**

Start Event – Status or Info Briefing Requested: A status or informational briefing may be requested from any stakeholder (e.g., NGA/R, MC&G PMO, Foundation GEOINT Production Office) to inform the FIRB about progress of an existing capability or on any other topic related to FG IT to keep the FIRB stakeholders informed. This includes topics related to funding, scheduling, organizational process changes, and product quality. Most commonly, this is an update on the development status of a capability being monitored. Other examples of status/info topics include modifications to the FG IT Capabilities Baseline, routine housekeeping updates provided by the SF IT Governance Team at each FIRB, an update on a Research-developed capability, or contract/funding updates relevant to FG IT.

Submit Presentation Request: The Requestor submits a presentation request to the SF IT Governance Team when ready to bring an informational briefing or status update of an existing activity to SF via the governance process. The Requestor will initiate this step based on when they expect to be ready to bring their topic to the FIRB. For example, if they would like to present to the FIRB in May, they would likely submit their request in early to mid-April. This request is less formal than a Capability Introduction or SF Mission Assessment briefing and is generally made directly to the SF IT

8 November 2024

FG Mission Planning [Final]

Foundation GEOINT Technology Division

As-Is Process Models

Governance Team via phone or email. At a minimum, the request must include the name and description of the topic and the name of the SF TX sponsor for the status or informational update to the FIRB.

Start Event – Ready for Capability Introduction or SF Mission Assessment: When SF has executed the New SF Capability Exploration Sub-Process and is ready to bring a topic to the larger SF audience, the Requestor (from a SF Production Office) submits a Capability Introduction request to the SF IT Governance Team. This process can also begin if a need for additional engineering support or funding is identified during the monitoring of an IT capability in development for a SF Production Office. The Requestor will generally know what type of briefing they are submitting a request for, but if they are uncertain, the SF IT Governance Team will assist them in finalizing the appropriate form of their briefing after the request is submitted.

Submit Capability Request: The Requestor submits a Capability Request to the SF IT Governance Team when ready to bring a Capability Introduction or Capability Assessment to SF via the governance process. The Requestor will initiate this step based on when they expect to be ready to brief the FIRB. For example, if they would like to present to the FIRB in May, they would likely submit their request in early to mid-April. The Requestor submits the request, which must include a Summary of the topic, Process Owner, Description, and estimated time to complete, via the Jira Business Case form via the FIRB Confluence space or via an e-mail or phone call to the SF IT Governance Team requesting to be placed on the FIRB agenda. If the request was made directly to the SF IT Governance Team, the Business Case form still needs to be submitted. If this is for a capability currently being monitored by the MC&G PMO it also will require a matured Technology Transition Agreement (TTA). The Requestor is always from an FG Production Office, and the topic must have the support of the office level TX, as a Sponsor, before it proceeds.

Assess Capability Request: Upon receipt of the Capability Request (i.e., Capability Introduction or Capability Assessment), the SF IT Governance Team and the Requestor coordinate to ensure that there is adequate information known about the capability to present it to the FIRB, and that the expectations of how this part of the process must function are clear. The SF IT Governance Team validates that there is a TX sponsor for the capability, identifies whether it is new or a modernization of an existing capability, determines if funding requests are involved, and asks other relevant questions to validate whether the topic should be presented as a Capability Introduction briefing or a Capability Assessment (e.g., if funding is requested it needs to be an assessment briefing, which requires a full Business Case). If this is a Research capability currently being monitored by the MC&G PMO, the SF IT Governance Team will review the TTA and confirm that it is mature enough to warrant a FIRB Capability Assessment decision. The SF IT Governance Team provides any necessary guidance to the Requestor to develop the correct materials for the FIRB (e.g., Business Case template PowerPoint charts) to ensure that adequate information will be included to provide value to SF and/or enable a Mission Owner decision (if needed). The SF IT Governance Team also confirms the feasibility of completing any required briefing materials or coordination tasks in time to meet the deadline for the upcoming FIRB date. When the request has been fully validated and confirmed for presentation to the FIRB, the Requestor is ready to complete the development of required briefing materials to enter the SF Mission Assessment Sub-Process.

Add Topic to FIRB Agenda: Once the type of briefing has been determined (i.e., Information, Status, Capability Introduction or Assessment) the SF IT Governance Team updates the FIRB agenda (via Confluence) with the target date for the topic to come to the FIRB. The agenda is in the form of a list and calendar update on the FIRB Confluence space, which is available for viewing by all individuals with access to the FIRB Confluence space.

8 November 2024

FG Mission Planning [Final]

Foundation GEOINT Technology Division

As-Is Process Models

Exclusive Gateway (Default / Briefing Materials Required): After confirming the topic for addition to the FIRB agenda, if development or update of briefing materials are required, the Requestor will initiate the task to generate the materials based on guidance from the SF IT Governance Team. Otherwise, the topic is ready for any stakeholder coordination required before the MO pre-brief.

Develop Briefing Materials: The Requestor will develop the appropriate slide deck based on the type of briefing they are providing. This process will begin once their request has been confirmed by the SF IT Governance Team, and they have a planned date to appear at the FIRB, though often the Requestor has existing briefing materials they can tailor to meet the needs of the governance process. Status briefings or informational briefings do not have a specific template and are short, as they are typically allocated about 10 minutes on the FIRB agenda. A slide deck is not currently required for status updates; a verbal update is sometimes adequate to inform the board. Capability Introduction briefings could be in any format and will include some of the information required for a business case, such as a description of the capability, the status, a recommendation, next steps, and must include a slide presented by the TX describing the value to the production office. The Research “new start” quad chart template is very often used in an intro briefing. Capability Assessment briefings, which are requesting a decision from the Mission Owner, require the completion of the full Business Case template in PowerPoint, along with any supplemental information the TX feels is necessary to inform the stakeholders and MO. Capability Assessments and Capability Introductions are allotted 20 minutes; the Requestor should plan accordingly when developing briefing materials. The Requestor will coordinate the business case development and/or briefing materials with the SF TX and any other immediate stakeholders (e.g., Research) as necessary. The level of coordination will vary based on the direction of the SF TX for the Requestor SF Production Office.

Submit Briefing Materials for Review: When the Requestor has completed the briefing materials (and coordinated with the sponsoring TX) they submit them to the SF IT Governance Team via e-mail or through the FIRB Confluence space (attached to a submitted Business Case). The Requestor must provide all briefing materials a week prior to the scheduled FIRB to ensure that the SF IT Governance Team has enough time to review, coordinate, and provide feedback on the materials that will be briefed.

Conduct Briefing Materials Review: The SF IT Governance Team reviews the submitted Business Case and/or briefing materials, to ensure that all required content is provided and clearly described. The SF IT Governance Team reaches out to the Requestor if they have any questions on the purpose/intent of the briefing, to clarify the ‘ask’ if there is one, set expectations for how the FIRB is run, and answer any questions. When this review is complete, the initial briefing materials are ready to be posted to Confluence for use at the FIRB. The SF IT Governance Team meets the Tuesday prior to the scheduled monthly FIRB session to refine the agenda and confirm that all planned topics are prepared for the FIRB. The SF IT Governance Team reviews and discusses each submission with the rest of the team, identifying any potential issues or ambiguous aspects of the briefing. They also ensure that a Business Case has a clear request, such as funding or engineering support, to facilitate the Mission Owner decision at the FIRB.

Exclusive Gateway (Default / MO Review Required): Materials that are ready and complete for the scheduled FIRB are first reviewed with the MO. If any rework is required or the SF IT Governance Team determines that the topic is not ready for a FIRB discussion it will be sent back to the Requestor to update the briefing materials.

Coordinate with Stakeholders: The SF IT Governance Team will identify additional stakeholders that should be involved in preparing for the topic briefing at the FIRB. Gathering information and validating awareness of the upcoming briefing with key stakeholders, using the briefing materials may be required to successfully conduct the FIRB, depending on the

8 November 2024

Foundation GEOINT Technology Division

FG Mission Planning [Final]

As-Is Process Models

breadth of impact of the topic. This task is complete once the SF IT Governance Team determines that the briefing has been socialized with the appropriate stakeholders.

Intermediate Event (Timer) – Wednesday Prior to FIRB Date: Informal reviews of briefing materials will continue up until the Wednesday prior to the FIRB each month. On Wednesday, the FIRB support staff will meet with the MC&G Mission Owner for a final review of the topics/briefings.

Conduct Mission Owner Pre-Brief: The SF IT Governance Team will meet with the MO to discuss any specifics of the submissions three business days prior to the scheduled FIRB and to conduct a final review of the topics/briefings. They will review the agenda and materials, and discuss any areas where improvements need to be made prior to the FIRB to ensure clarity and relevancy. For example, the MO may have additional questions to better understand the scope of the request, a desire for more information on a given topic, or feedback on the briefing charts that should be incorporated by the Requestor prior to the FIRB. Projected alignment with the FG IT Capabilities Baseline is also discussed during this session. The MO will confirm whether all agenda items can proceed as planned, or whether any topics need to be deferred to a future date. Once this step is finished, the team will address any outstanding topics and confirm the agenda for the upcoming FIRB with the SF IT Governance Team.

Update FIRB Agenda: The Friday before the FIRB, the SF IT Governance Team updates the agenda for the appropriate FIRB on the FIRB Confluence space to reflect the upcoming briefings, whether they are status briefings, capability introductions, or new business cases for SF assessment. If the topic has been deferred, the SF IT Governance Team communicates this decision with the Requestor and asks for the briefing materials to be updated and resubmitted for a later FIRB. The SF IT Governance Team then removes it from the agenda and updates the entry in Jira (if applicable). If it was confirmed, the SF IT Governance Team validates the briefing title/topic, presenter, and date on the agenda. If minor updates to the briefing materials are required, the SF IT Governance Team communicates these changes to the Requestor, who updates the briefing materials and resubmits them prior to the FIRB date. If the topic is an Introduction or a Capability Assessment, the SF IT Governance Team also attaches the briefing materials to the business case entry in Jira and attaches the briefing materials to the Outlook meeting invite and sends it out to the FIRB stakeholders.

Exclusive Gateway (Deferred or Update Requested/Confirmed for FIRB): For those briefings that have been confirmed by the MO, the process is complete for this topic, which is ready for presentation to the FIRB. If updates to the briefing materials are required prior to presenting to the FIRB, the Requestor must complete those updates and resubmit the briefing.

Update Briefing Materials: Should the SF IT Governance Team or SF IT Governance Team reviews result in the need to update the briefing materials, the Requestor will make the necessary changes and resubmit the briefing materials. This can apply to any type of topic (e.g., status/info briefing, Capability Introduction, Capability Assessment) that is missing key information, or needs to be modified based on pre-FIRB reviews. Once the Requestor has met the criteria communicated by the SF IT Governance Team, they will re-submit their Business Case or briefing for review.

End Event – Ready for SF Mission Assessment (FIRB): Once the briefing content has been reviewed and accepted by the SF IT Governance Team, and the agenda has been updated, the topic is ready for SF review and/or Assessment at the FIRB.

See Appendix A and B for a numbered version and tabular view of this sub-process.

FG Capability Assessment Preparation Enabling Technology

- **Jira:** A web-based service that provides agile project management via tracking mechanisms and programmatic reports (e.g., tracking burndown, velocity, time/business value) so that general production states can be assessed. The content in the FIRB instance of Jira captures a description of current and past capability introduction and capability assessment topics brought to the FIRB. In this process Jira is used as a way to track Capability Introduction or Capability Assessment requests. Topics submitted via the Business Case form on the FIRB Confluence page are captured in Jira, and relevant documents (e.g., briefing charts) are attached to the Jira entry.
- **Confluence Space:** A web-based corporate wiki used for collaboration that assists users to create, organize, and share work utilizing Artificial Intelligence (AI). It is used in this process to submit business cases to the FIRB, display upcoming FIRB agenda topics, briefing due dates, Points of Contact (PoCs), reference information and acts as the FIRB Splash Page.
- **Microsoft Office Suite:** The Microsoft Office Suite is a collection of applications that help users with productivity and common computer tasks. The suite includes programs like Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook, OneNote, Publisher, and Access. In this process, PowerPoint is used for almost all FIRB briefings to include the FIRB Business Case template used for a Capability Introduction or Capability Assessment request.
- **Microsoft Outlook:** Microsoft Outlook is a personal information manager software system from Microsoft, available as a part of the Microsoft 365 suite. Used in this process by the SF IT Governance Team and stakeholders for email coordination, delivery of pre-read and reference information (that is attached via Confluence) and meeting management.
- **Microsoft Teams:** Microsoft Teams is a team collaboration application developed by Microsoft as part of the Microsoft 365 family of products, offering workspace chat and video conferencing, file storage, and proprietary and third-party application integration. Teams is used by the SF IT Governance Team for coordination throughout the process.

FG Capability Assessment Preparation Pain Points

1. The SF IT Governance Team needs to better understand where capabilities fit into the FG IT configuration control baseline. Today there is not clear method to determine whether a capability aligns with the current baseline, and establishing this alignment is not an activity being conducted as part of governance on a regular basis. A repeatable process to address this activity and integrate it into the FG prioritization framework is crucial to successfully manage the portfolio of capabilities through the FG IT Governance process. See related To-Be Note #14.
2. Topics submitted for assessment are currently evaluated for readiness to come to the FIRB based primarily on the maturity of the capability and completeness of the Business Case. External factors are not taken into consideration (SF priorities, budget, etc.). Better tracking of knowns/unknowns and information that would be of the greatest value to support governance decisions is needed. Decisions could be made more effectively and in terms of strategic (i.e., 'big picture') value and impact if this information were incorporated into the initial assessment of candidate capabilities. See related To-Be Note #3.

3. Multiple SF and Research stakeholders are concerned about the delay and lack of action and/or awareness of status that occurs after providing a Capability Introduction (via the SF Mission Assessment process). Support for tracking the capability through the rest of the governance process and providing routine status would help avoid unnecessary delays or miscommunications on when certain actions should be taken (e.g., return to the FIRB for a status update, engineering request, etc.). Additionally, regular updates may uncover opportunities for collaboration across the organization if there are similar needs and/or requirements across production offices and may help facilitate planning and integration of capabilities for the benefit of SF as a whole. See related To-Be Note #18 (in Overview section).
4. FG Production offices sometimes propose Introductions to the FIRB for capabilities that they are developing on their own with limited MC&G PMO engagement (e.g., Maritime Safety Office (SFH) Bathymetric Self Service). Lack of consistent insight into the status of these capabilities after they come to the FIRB (e.g., managed by MC&G, targeted for transition to MC&G, etc.) reduces the potential value the governance process could provide. See related To-Be Note #10d (and #19 in overview).

FG Capability Assessment Preparation To-Be Notes

Identifying Topics for SF Mission Assessment (FIRB)

1. The SF IT Governance Team should further define the differences between the three types of topics that enter the SF Mission Assessment process (via the FIRB). Providing discrete guidance on when and how an Introduction, Assessment, and Status update need to come to the FIRB, as well as their respective paths through the end-to-end process, would provide needed guidance to stakeholders, and potentially identify opportunities to address some functions in different ways (e.g., via separate meetings). See related To-Be Note #3.
2. SF would like to expand upon the utilization and scope of Capability Introduction briefings for relevant FG IT topics that do not require additional funding. Capability Introductions have largely been provided by Research. In the future, a broader spectrum of stakeholder groups should be utilizing these briefings to enhance collaboration and awareness, identify synergies early in capability exploration, and provide greater value to the SF mission as a whole, through managed information-sharing. SFC would like to establish a consistent set of criteria, along with expected value, to determine how Capability Introduction topics should be identified for review by the FIRB.
3. SFC should work with SF to identify a high-level set of business rules governing what topics are presented to the FIRB, based on anticipated value. The primary goal would be to establish clear criteria for when topics are **required** to come to the FIRB, as well as criteria for optional topics. Value to the SF mission should be addressed as part of these discussions (e.g., avoiding future development delays, establishing a record of concurrence of a mission need across SF, acquiring MC&G PMO support for a needed engineering study, potential integration across production offices, etc.). See related To-Be Note #1 and SFMA To-Be Note #3.
4. The SF IT Governance Team should consider generating a more detailed set of guidance to post as reference material for those who bring a topic to the FIRB. Conversations should be held to confirm the appropriate list of topics to include in this reference material, as well as the appropriate levels of detail to cater to different audiences. An easy-to-find reference of this nature will help communicate information about the FIRB and how

8 November 2024

Foundation GEOINT Technology Division

FG Mission Planning [Final]

As-Is Process Models

to actively participate in the governance forum for maximum value. This reference material should include, at a minimum:

- a. A clear description of the FIRB and its purpose in the context of the overarching Governance process
 - b. The criteria to determine when a topic must, should, or could come to the FIRB, depending on the type of FIRB topic in question (See related To-Be Note #3)
 - c. Clearly laid out steps for an individual to request, prepare, and present a topic for the FIRB
5. SFC and the MC&G PMO need to determine the business rules for when a vetted position from the MC&G PMO should be returned to the FIRB / MO. Discussions are currently in progress (Q1CY2024). Details of how this process should function, along with how it relates to the Mission Owner adjudication of the engineering (i.e., TRB) recommendations, need to be discussed. For example, the Mission Owner may leverage the FIRB audience to clarify mission implications of TRB recommendation and choose to make a decision either as part of the FIRB, or after the meeting has occurred. Definition of these business rules will provide consistency and further the ability of the FG IT governance process to provide visibility, transparency and follow-thru and track the status and disposition of topics post-FIRB/TRB.
6. A specific list of significant circumstances that would require a return to the FIRB should be developed (e.g., no appropriate contract, another enterprise-wide or Intelligence Community (IC) shared services capability has been identified, which would meet the intended requirement of the proposed capability, etc.). This list could be utilized by SF and engineering teams to help identify circumstances, which warrant a return of a topic to the FIRB, to minimize time spent against high-risk efforts without input from the MC&G MO and SF TXs.
7. The SF IT Governance Team wants to centralize all external requests of the FIRB to a single portal entry point. The goal of this portal is to simplify the process for requestors, so users are not forced to submit different types of topics in different manners. The SF IT Governance Management Team should discuss the intended configuration of this process and confirm that the single-entry point will work for all potential FIRB types.
8. The SF IT Governance Team should pursue the formal use of established FG Solution Epics (SEs) to structure the FG IT Governance process and improve the relevance of the FIRB to the broader requirements process. Ideally, when a topic comes to the FIRB, the appropriate SE should already be identified, and the capability in question should address a specific aspect of the SE. Further discussion should explore the benefit of addressing potential solutions at the function level (Minimum Viable Product functions (MVPf)) as part of the preparation to bring a topic or concept to the FIRB for discussion. In addition to reducing the number of topics coming to the FIRB seemingly 'out of the blue', this approach would leverage the existing requirements engineering process to depict how a proposed capability fits with the overarching goals of the solution architecture.
9. In conjunction with To-Be Note #8, the SF IT Governance Team should develop a process to connect capabilities that are NOT related to an existing SE in the existing requirements process. Discussion should include validating that capabilities that do not align to an existing SE should have a process for funding/implementation (e.g., if they are vetted by the FIRB and deemed to be high priority enough for further pursuit). These discussions should involve working with FG PMs to identify the lead time required to update an SE for the next POM cycle, in order to establish a clear schedule for the funding of new capabilities in line with the requirements process. Establishing this process will further enhance the value of the FIRB, as it will socialize and approve new

capabilities and concepts for inclusion in the overarching FG Solution Architecture. Additionally, this enhanced governance process would provide a means to initiate updates to (or creation of new) Solution Epics for the appropriate PMs to manage these capabilities through the requirements process.

FIRB Management / Tracking

10. In the near-term, SFC would like to build out a semi-automated workflow management capability utilizing the JIRA site to improve communication and efficiency in managing the FIRB. Potential topics for investigation:
 - a. Develop a status/dashboard for FIRB topics (e.g., Capability Introduction Complete, etc.) and allow for enabling the use of categories in a project tracker type view. See related To-Be Note #11b.
 - b. Enable a capability whereby the data associated with the Business Case would be submitted directly via the FIRB Jira instance, to trigger the appropriate workflow status.
 - c. Identify additional opportunities for increased efficiency (e.g., providing a notification to SF TX teams when pre-reads are posted to Jira.)
 - d. Integrate Jira workflows of the FIRB and TRB in order to track items that have gone to the TRB and need to return to the FIRB to facilitate more efficient and complete collaboration between SF and the MC&G PMO regarding IT capabilities.
11. SFC would like to explore the development of a data-driven approach to gather and manage FIRB requests/capabilities, in contrast to the as-is process, which employs static documents/artifacts, manually managed agenda topics, and templates and briefings. Significant value is expected from this shift to a data-centric management approach, captured in specific topics listed below. The key data required for a Business Case (or other type of FIRB request) should be identified and collected as part of the initial Request and managed as a large dataset of information on FG IT capabilities/topics as they relate to the governance process. This would require mapping out the data required for each of the types of FIRB topics, to include the significant milestones that would provide valuable insight into the progress of a capability through the governance process (to include MO approvals). Specific topics to explore in order to design and implement a data-centric management approach include:
 - a. Discuss possible approaches to generate a 'Business Case' whereby the 'data' feeds into the creation of a report or artifact that summarizes the topic, tracks it through the governance process, serves as a record, etc. See related To-Be Note #11 for more information.
 - b. Define the vision for a Kanban board or other similar type of dynamic dashboard that could utilize data inputs to visualize key metrics related to governance (e.g., number of capabilities in each stage of the process), and clearly depict the status of each capability (e.g., 'Scheduled for Capability Introduction', 'Approved for Engineering Assessment', etc.). This functionality would provide insight into the real-time status of IT Capabilities that have entered the governance process, a request that has been made by many of the IT Governance stakeholders, to include SF TXs. See related To-Be Note #10a.
 - c. Identify the desired status categories for FIRB topics (e.g., 'submitted', 'scheduled', 'completed', 'withdrawn') to ensure that tracking and reporting on FIRB-centric governance activities is well defined and consistently understood.
 - d. Define the ideal business rules for when a topic/capability is ready for each stage in the governance process (e.g., Capability Introduction, Capability Assessment, Capability Status, etc.), as well as the

data/fields required to automatically implement these rules within the governance workflow. The purpose of this data would be to alert stakeholders as to when a topic is ready to move to the next stage in the process, or when it should return to the FIRB for a status update. This activity would add clarity to the requirements of the governance process and aims to avoid topics' 'falling off the radar' out of a lack of clarity regarding next steps.

- e. Implement the ability to build on the information contained in a Business Case (or other instantiation of a FIRB topic/capability), rather than create a new submission for each major milestone or status update as it progresses through the governance process. Preferably, the first instance of capturing data related to a topic should be collected far earlier in the process than it is today (at the submission of a Business Case request). Building on the same submission (e.g., when submitting an Assessment request, data fields from the Capability Introduction request could already be populated, and available to be edited during the submission of the Business Case for the Assessment.) will introduce greater consistency in communicating about the topic over its lifecycle, introduce efficiencies with re-use of common data, and feed into associated metrics and status views or reports. Capturing the information earlier in the lifecycle and building on the information relating to governance decisions for the topic will provide greater insight into the history and context of a given topic/capability and assist leaders in decision making based on key data points collected throughout the governance timeline.
12. The SF IT Governance Team would like to begin sending relevant materials to the FIRB stakeholders prior to the monthly FIRB. Details need to be discussed, to include the recipient list, the specific list of items included, and the changes to the process to properly accommodate this new step. As a starting point, the SF IT Governance Mission Manager would like FIRB stakeholders to receive read-ahead materials seven days prior to the FIRB meeting. These materials would include the actual briefing to the FIRB, any pertinent process documentation, any Rough Orders of Magnitude (ROMs) or other known cost estimate information, along with any suggested existing contracts/funding vehicles that may be suitable should the capability be funded. This pre-work is designed to prepare FIRB members to vote without much delay or discussion. See Related To-Be Note #13.
 13. SFC would like to explore opportunities to optimize the way stakeholders receive the information they need to properly prepare for value-added discussion and rapid decision-making at the FIRB. This may involve improving the process to finalize the agenda and the activities surrounding the advance briefings/pre-reads, potentially in a semi-automated fashion. Distributing pre-reads will be helpful, allowing stakeholders to review the briefings and be ready to discuss and provide input to the MC&G MO. Presentations are currently uploaded to the FIRB Jira instance, and SFC would like to investigate incorporating a mechanism to more easily notify stakeholders that a pre-read is ready, confirm that they have seen it, and potentially submit advance feedback/questions in order to further streamline the FIRB session itself. In addition:
 - a. SFC would like to explore the development of the process to coordinate the distribution and review of pre-reads before the FIRB occurs. In addition to the FIRB briefing charts, these materials may also include pertinent process documentation, cost estimates, and suggested existing contract vehicles that may be suitable should the capability be funded. Details such as the timing of distribution of pre-reads, the means to notify appropriate stakeholders of pre-read availability, and whether other activities (e.g., validating participation of key SF SMEs ahead of time) should be part of this process to further improve the effectiveness of the FIRB.

- b. SFC would like to explore the value in incorporating status updates on the Confluence space (e.g., FIRB Splash Page); one option to consider would be an announcement block. This method of updating could be a helpful supplement to the current process, reaching all who view the Confluence space, rather than solely those on an e-mail distribution list or in attendance at the meetings. In the as-is process, status updates are provided via meetings and emails.
- 14. SFC would like to define the coordination process and activities associated with handling changes to the FG IT configuration control baseline. In the future, all modifications or changes to the baseline (e.g., adding a new swim lane in a future tracking capability, etc.) should start at the FIRB, rather than the TRB unless it is a new topic being presented for the first time. The change detection capability baseline, for instance, is a future state idea. Furthermore, TXs will need to be informed as to which board is appropriate for the submission of baseline changes. In the as-is process, the team uses a high side SharePoint site to accomplish portions of these activities in place today. The future process should reduce the complexity of updating the IT baseline and complement the rest of the governance process, ensuring that changes are socialized with all stakeholders.
 - a. To facilitate the coordination described above, SFC has begun to explore adding a step to the initial business case development process. The sponsoring office TX will offer their recommendation on where the requested need falls within the IT priorities of their production office as part of the briefing to the FIRB. This will help the MC&G MO understand where the request fits within the overall FG priorities (i.e., 1-n list), which is essential in making an informed decision.
- 15. In the future, the TX Sponsor will be required to inform the Office Director of any topics they bring to the FIRB before the FIRB date. The SF IT Governance Team will verify with the Requestor whether this socialization has occurred once they submit their briefing materials for review. This socialization step will enhance awareness of key capabilities and their status within the FG IT Governance process across SF and ensure that no topics are brought before the FIRB without the awareness of the sponsoring FG Office leadership.
- 16. SFC would like to explore the potential options to automate (or semi-automate) the process for developing briefing materials (i.e., Business Case, Capability Introduction, Status Update, etc.). Ideally, the information captured in the Business Case (from the As-Is process) could be continually utilized and augmented throughout the lifecycle of the capability, rather than ceasing upon its presentation to the FIRB (See Related To-Be Note #11 re: data-driven management approach). If all required information is captured at initial submission and augmented as a topic/capability proceeds through the governance process, automatically generating reports or inputs to the briefing charts could save significant time and ensure consistency in communicating meaningful components of the topic. Specific aspects to explore include:
 - a. Identify the information required for each type of FIRB topic (e.g., Capability Assessment, Capability Introduction, Status Update, Informational Briefing). Ensure that templates are developed for each type, with Capability Introduction as the first priority after Capability Assessment (which has an existing template that can be updated). The Research “quad” is a helpful starting point to influence the future Capability Introduction template, as it contains helpful information that can serve as a baseline.
 - b. Identify a location and develop a process to capture all the required information in one place (see related To Be Note #7).

- c. Explore alternatives to automatically generate reports, visualizations, and/or briefing materials directly from the submitted data points about each topic.

8 November 2024

FG Mission Planning [Final]

Foundation GEOINT Technology Division

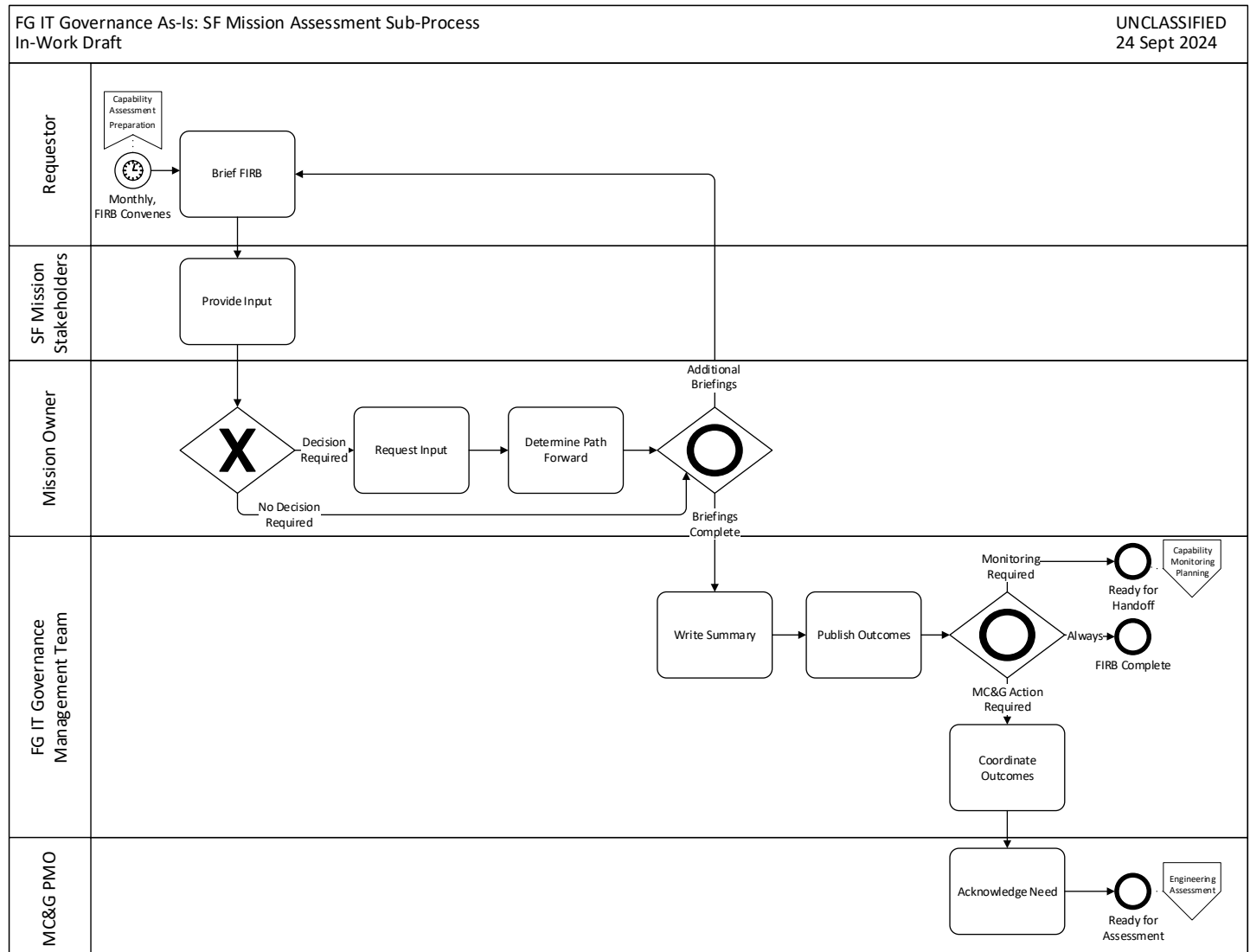
As-Is Process Models

SF Mission Assessment Sub-Process As-Is Process Model

SF Mission Assessment Introduction

The Mission Assessment Sub-Process describes the primary required steps and possible outcomes associated with the management and execution of the monthly FIRB, the governing body for vetting, validating, and prioritizing FG IT requirements for SF. The input to this sub-process is a set of topics (i.e., Capability Introduction, Capability Assessment, Information Briefing or Status Update), pre-approved by the SF IT Governance Team in the Capability Assessment Preparation Sub-Process. The SF IT Governance Team, the SF Production Office Technical Executives (TXs), and presenters/SMEs for each topic are the key participants in the FIRB, with the SF MO presiding as the primary decision authority. Each topic is presented to the FIRB attendees, and if a decision is required, the SF MO provides this decision during the meeting. After the conclusion of the FIRB monthly session, the SF IT Governance Team facilitates hand-off to other governance entities (i.e., MC&G TRB, PoC for capability monitoring) if applicable and ensures that the outcomes of the FIRB are published for awareness and as permanent record.

SF Mission Assessment Sub-Process Model



SF Mission Assessment Sub-Process Model Definitions

Start Event (Timer) – Monthly, FIRB Convenes: The sub-process begins on the first Monday of every month, when the FIRB is scheduled to convene. This 2-hour virtual forum is held at the unclassified level, and all of the topics on the agenda have been approved by the SF IT Governance Team and MC&G Mission Owner in the Capability Assessment Preparation Sub-Process. The Requestor of the first agenda item is prepared to brief one of four possible types of briefings: Capability Assessment, Capability Introduction, Information Briefing or Status Update.

Brief FIRB: The Requestor presents a briefing package, which has already been reviewed and approved by the SF IT Governance Team. Each briefing has a specific purpose and may include a request for a decision from the MO. The Requestor may be seeking funding, requesting engineering support for a new need or capability, providing an update on the development of a capability, or presenting information to provide situational awareness across SF.

Provide Input: The SF Mission stakeholders in attendance at the FIRB, which include TXs from each SF Mission Production Office have the opportunity to ask questions to better understand how the topic may impact their office. They also may opt to offer relevant insight for the benefit of SF overall or to enhance the governance process.

Exclusive Gateway (Decision Required / No Decision Required): If the topic briefed is either an Information Briefing or a Status Update and no decision is required, the process bypasses the subsequent decision-related steps. If a decision or next steps are required for the topic that has just been briefed, the Mission Owner will request input as needed to make their decision.

Request Input: The Mission Owner may desire additional stakeholder input prior to making a decision with respect to the topic. The MO will ask specific questions or seek other input from stakeholders, to include MC&G PMO representatives if they are in attendance. The scope of this input may be broader than that which is provided during the “Provide Input” step, which centers around the Production Office perspective.

Determine Path Forward: The Mission Owner uses the input provided, as well as the SF priorities, to determine how to proceed for the decision brief presented (either a Capability Assessment or Capability Introduction). Typically, the MO will determine that additional engineering assessment via the MC&G PMO is required or that the new capability should be monitored until further progress is made.

Inclusive Gateway (Additional Briefings / Briefings Complete): If there are additional topics to be briefed at this point, the process begins again with the next Requestor providing their briefing. If all agenda topics have been briefed, then the board meeting is complete, and the SF IT Governance Team begins to write the summary of the session.

Write Summary: Once the meeting is adjourned, the SF IT Governance Team writes a summary to document the decisions made during the FIRB. The summary does not include details related to the briefings for which no decision or further action is required, as meeting minutes are not captured at a detailed level⁶.

Publish Outcomes: The SF IT Governance Team posts the summary document and any other relevant materials to Jira to serve as a permanent record of decisions; and the briefings and meeting recording to Inteldocs for future reference.

⁶ Each FIRB session is recorded and made available to all stakeholders.

8 November 2024

FG Mission Planning [Final]

Foundation GEOINT Technology Division

As-Is Process Models

Inclusive Gateway (Monitoring Required / Always / MC&G Action Required): At this point in the process, the monthly FIRB is always complete. If additional monitoring or planning for an emerging capability is required, the SF IT Governance Team will work to stay informed as to upcoming activities related to the capability. If MC&G action is required, the SF IT Governance Team will work with the appropriate MC&G PMO PoC to coordinate the next steps.

End Event – FIRB Complete: Once the outcomes of the FIRB have been published, the FIRB session activities are considered complete. For any briefing topics that did not require monitoring or action by MC&G, the SF Mission Assessment Sub-Process is complete.

End Event – Ready for Handoff: The capability has completed the SF Mission Assessment Sub-Process and will enter the Engineering Integration Monitoring/Planning Sub-Process.

Coordinate Outcomes: If a FIRB topic is deemed to require an MC&G Engineering Assessment at the TRB, the SF IT Governance Team will coordinate with the appropriate MC&G PMO PoC to transition/transfer ownership and responsibility for the capability/capability need in question to them. This involves providing all associated documentation that the FIRB currently has within Jira relevant to the capability/capability need [i.e., business case, cost assessment, Concepts of Operations (CONOPs), operational views, proofs of concept, pilot or prototype materials, etc.]

Acknowledge Need: The MC&G PMO PoC officially assumes responsibility for the next steps for the capability/capability need and will follow their process via the TRB to initiate an engineering assessment.

End Event – Ready for Assessment: The topic is ready for the MC&G PMO to begin the engineering assessment.

See Appendix C and D for a numbered version and tabular view of this sub-process.

SF Mission Assessment Sub-Process Enabling Technology

- **Inteldocs:** A document management repository available to the Intelligence Community for cross-Agency collaboration purposes. Used in this process to host recordings of previous FIRB briefings. The recordings are stored in Inteldocs due to file size limitations associated with Jira.
- **Jira:** A web-based service that provides agile project management via tracking mechanisms, user notifications and programmatic reports (e.g., tracking burndown, velocity, time/business value) so that general production states can be assessed. The content in the FIRB instance of Jira captures a description of current and past capability introduction and capability assessment topics brought to the FIRB. In this process it is used to track decisions made and the status of topics post FIRB. Relevant documents received as part of a specific decision topic and shared with key stakeholders (e.g., MC&G PMO) are attached to the Jira entry.
- **Microsoft Office Suite:** The Microsoft Office Suite is a collection of applications that help users with productivity and common computer tasks. The suite includes programs like Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook, OneNote, Publisher, and Access. In this process the SF IT Governance Team utilizes PowerPoint to present the briefings during the session and Word to generate the FIRB summary document.
- **Microsoft Outlook:** Microsoft Outlook is a personal information manager software system used in this process by the SF IT Governance Team and stakeholders for publishing the outcomes of the FIRB and coordination with the MC&G PMO.

- **Microsoft Teams:** Microsoft Teams is a collaboration application developed by Microsoft as part of the Microsoft 365 family of products, offering workspace chat and video conferencing, file storage, and proprietary and third-party application integration. FIRB sessions are run, recorded, and transcribed virtually via Teams, and it is also used by the SF IT Governance Team for coordination throughout the process.

SF Mission Assessment Sub-Process Pain Points

1. The current process routes all key decisions to the MC&G Mission Owner rather than being shared across multiple stakeholders or leadership members. Additionally, the priorities framework that should ideally feed MC&G Mission Owner decisions is not integrated into the governance process. This approach places significant responsibility on a single individual for decision-making and does not adequately allow for stakeholder (e.g., FG TX) input, which could lead to conflicts over allocation of funds to one Production Office over another. See related To-Be Notes #3, #5 and #15 in the Overview section.
2. The FIRB process is currently inadequate to support the requirements process. For example, the Maritime requirement to migrate from the S-57 format to the S-101 is a huge problem to solve that encompasses all phases of mission execution and will impact multiple existing systems and require new capabilities. This cannot be presented in the current 5 chart FIRB business case template. A lot of effort is put in to developing Solution Epics to capture production office needs; however, this does not seem to be tied to the FG IT Governance Process and the capability needs are merely provided to an MC&G PMO engineer to “figure it out.” Without a relationship between the governance process and the existing requirements efforts (e.g., Solution Epics), the governance process will struggle to support the development of these capabilities. See related To-Be Notes #8& #9 within the CAP section.
3. It is unclear which topics, and at what point in their lifecycle, they need to be brought to the FIRB. The SF IT Governance Team needs to define the criteria for when a topic requires FIRB/MO approval (e.g., Do all new capability needs come to the FIRB? Does every business case that costs money require a FIRB briefing? Do potential cost savings efforts require FIRB/MO approval? Often work can be done on existing contracts to build or enhance capabilities. What are the criteria for bringing these types of efforts to the FIRB?). See related CAP To-Be Notes #2 and #3.
4. The existing process does not assist the Production Offices in getting the solutions they need into operations. The FIRB often acts as a roadblock, requiring more work for the Production Offices to answer questions about their requirement instead of validating the requirement to progress with solution development and/or integration into operations.
 - a. The path to operations is unclear, and this is impacting the success of implementing new capabilities required to meet the FG mission. The readiness process once had a clearly defined Initial Operational Capability (IOC) and Full Operational Capability (FOC); however, the meaning of these states within the acquisition process has become muddled. See related To-Be Note #2.
5. At some FIRB sessions, it seems as though not enough information is available, and/or not enough pre-socialization has occurred for the MO to make an effective decision. A more deliberate process is required before each FIRB to ensure that the MO is familiar with the ‘ask’ and will have all the information they need to make the requested decision at the FIRB. Without improvements in this area, the ability of the MO to make an

appropriate decision will continue to be inconsistent, and the value of the FIRB and the governance process will be lessened. See related To-Be Notes #6f, #13, and CAP #12 and #13.

SF Mission Assessment Sub-Process To-Be Notes

1. The MC&G MO currently utilizes a core set of 'Guiding Principles'⁷, as well as SF mission priorities, to inform decision making. In the future, the Corporate Operations and Technology Office (SFC) and the MO should formally define these principles and ensure alignment with SF priorities, to increase transparency and facilitate socialization. A formally documented set of guiding principles will also enable quicker and simpler updates, as mission priorities evolve.
2. Currently, the SF Mission Assessment (i.e., FIRB) Sub-Process focuses primarily on evaluating specific technical solutions against FG Mission needs. The long-term vision for the sub-process involves executing the FIRB earlier in the governance cycle, when a need/issue is identified, rather than after a specific technology or solution has been identified. SFC and FG IT Governance stakeholders should collaborate on opportunities to shift the focus towards analyzing SF mission needs and identify areas where the governance process can evolve to achieve this aspect of the long-term vision. This approach would better leverage the broader SF expertise at the FIRB and the engineering resources of the TRB to innovate integrated solutions to mission challenges.
3. If there is conflict between the MC&G Mission Owner and/or any of the key stakeholders (e.g., SF TXs, Office directors, Senior GEOINT Officers (SGOs), et al.) during the SF Mission Assessment (i.e., FIRB) or when the MO is determining the implementation decision, the decision will be escalated to the SF leadership level. Implementing a formal process for escalating these FIRB decisions will consistently ensure that actions can be taken with minimal delays and confusion when consensus is not achieved during a FIRB session.
4. SF Leadership, specifically the Director and Deputy Director of the Foundation GEOINT Group (SF), would like the governance process to provide them with regular updates to keep SF leadership informed of key FIRB/MO decisions, how SF priorities are being accomplished, and alert them to any potential conflicts or decisions that will require action on their part. Further discussion is required between FIRB leadership, the MC&G Mission Owner, and the SF Director to determine the best way to implement this step in the process, preferably by utilizing an existing forum (e.g., SF senior staff meetings) to convey these updates.
5. The SF TXs and the MC&G Mission Owner are currently the only members of SF leadership with a clearly defined role in the governance process. SFC should work across SF to determine whether other areas of SF leadership should be formally involved in the process (e.g., Senior GEOINT Officers (SGOs), Office Directors, Branch Chiefs, et al.). These discussions should identify the unique value or efficiency that each role would add to the governance process. Identifying the SF roles that should participate in the FG IT Governance process will ensure rigor and validity of the process and will minimize delays when the appropriate leaders are in the room to provide input to key decisions.

⁷ Guiding Principles are not yet a formalized artifact and may change over time as goals are accomplished and new focus areas are defined. Currently these include integration of processes and data across FG domains, maximizing the use of FG enterprise solutions, improved data-centricity, addressing fiscal efficiency (i.e., "do more with less") and enabling modernization leading to Foundation Digital Twin (FDT).

6. Several improvements to the logistics of the FIRB and communication of FG IT needs and capability status should be considered based on feedback gathered from multiple stakeholder groups. To assist with stakeholder notification, preparation, and action after the review board, the following improvements should be implemented:
 - a. Publicize the deadline for submission (e.g., six business days prior to the FIRB).
 - b. Publicize the final agenda and required attendees at least three business days prior to the FIRB.
 - c. Make available the presentation and discussion materials to all stakeholders prior to the start of the FIRB. This will assist those that want to review the material prior to the presentation and/or reference the materials on their own during the FIRB.
 - d. Ensure that all current and historical materials are easy to discover and readily available.
 - e. Provide the link to the location of current and historical FIRB materials (e.g., FIRB Confluence Space) each time a communication (e.g., FIRB meeting invite) is sent related to the FIRB.
 - f. Evolve the approach to pre-meetings with the Mission Owner to ensure maximum decision-making capacity and appropriate alignment with the TRB capacities (See related To-Be Note #13).
7. To aid in communicating the status of prior FIRB topics to all stakeholders, the SF IT Governance Team should provide a recap and update on prior decisions made by the FIRB/MO as well as a future prediction of what is up next for FIRB/MO introductions or decisions. This information should become a staple segment at the beginning or end of the FIRB to help with stakeholder perceptions and concerns that previous topics are not continuing to move through the process. Providing a status for all needs or capabilities that have come through the FIRB and still require action would ensure that all stakeholders understand where their need is within the process and eliminate the perception that it is no longer being monitored within the governance process. Clearly aligning the various decisions/topics to the stakeholder organizations could also be beneficial to allow for stakeholders to quickly discover the topics of greatest interest to them. The ability to show and measure the capabilities that successfully made it through the entire process and are being integrated or sustained by the MC&G PMO should also be considered. This information would be beneficial for assessing how well the governance process is working, identifying areas of improvement, and highlighting for all stakeholders the success of the process. See Related CAP TBN #10.
8. The FIRB would potentially be an effective means to address capability needs that span across multiple SF mission areas (e.g., FG Dissemination), given the participation in the process by all the SF offices. In the current process, the SF Mission Assessment step (i.e., FIRB) generally focuses on what each FG office requests (e.g., funds and/or engineering support) to support their piece of the FG mission. SF TXs do believe that this is a helpful function, as it helps them better understand what potential solutions are being assessed for other production offices, though the assembled SF TX team could also be leveraged to address more activities that impact multiple production offices, which has not been very common. The SF IT governance Team should work with the MC&G Mission Owner and SF TXs to establish a list of the most important topics (e.g., specific capabilities required to support FG Dissemination, Foundation Digital Twin, etc.) that span across the SF mission and identify the appropriate way to effectively address them within the FG IT governance process. Additionally, the SF IT Governance Team should consider shifting some of the focus away from individual technology proposals. Instead, they should establish a set of processes to help identify needs/capabilities (instead of

solutions) and bring more of these through the SF Mission Assessment process to leverage cross-cutting opportunities to develop solutions that benefit SF as a whole. Any adjustments to the overall function of the FIRB should preserve the current value of elevating awareness across SF of what each office is doing, in order to identify opportunities for re-use, to minimize potential conflicts, and enhance information sharing. See related To-Be Note #2.

9. SF TX participation in the FIRB is beneficial from a situational awareness perspective, but in the future, the role of the SF TX team at the FIRB should be re-assessed to further increase the value of their involvement. While there is an opportunity for the TXs to speak at the FIRB on a given topic, this is not a formal part of the process (i.e., they are not directly asked for their opinions on every decision). Additionally, the topics coming to the FIRB today primarily address the needs of a single production office, and other TXs would have minimal weigh-in regarding these topics.
10. The SF IT Governance Team should hold further discussions on the overall purpose of the FIRB (see To-Be Note #8) as it evolves, to further address opportunities to obtain formal input from TXs and hold targeted discussions on topics relevant across SF (e.g., prioritization). This type of shift could better leverage the FIRB attendees' perspectives and provide more discrete input from the production offices to support decision-making.
11. The SF IT Governance Team would like to leverage TRB charter content and assess combining the respective Board templates, to enhance coordination between the two teams, as well as specify inputs that are desired today but should be required in the future.
12. The SF IT Governance Team and the TRB Secretariat should investigate a modernized solution to combine or link related information currently tracked on the FIRB and TRB Jira pages. A more united solution would enable timely status updates and more streamlined, collaborative information sharing across SF and the MC&G PMO, minimizing reliance on email and sequential postings across multiple decoupled platforms. For instance, integration and/or synced Jira pages would allow stakeholders to track the outcomes of FIRB briefings that have been assigned to the MC&G PMO for an engineering assessment. Another related approach could be an end-to-end dashboard that tracks the status of capability needs in development for access by all interested stakeholders. Finally, this integration would enable a Lean business case template that could be pre-filled partially by the SF IT Governance Team initially to be augmented by MC&G PMO as it proceeds through the engineering assessment.
13. The SF IT Governance Team needs to ensure that any ask that may involve the MC&G PMO/TRB is coordinated prior to the FIRB to determine whether resources are available; what the trade might be if needed to activate resources; what the rough timelines would be for engineering support; and whether a different FIRB date would better align with the MC&G support capacity. Along these lines, the team should also consider adding a step in the Capability Assessment Preparation Sub-Process to identify, monitor, and socialize any schedule changes that result from this pre-coordination to ensure that the topic is properly tracked. [Note: The MC&G PMO prefers that TRB decisions advance to the following TRB session, whenever possible or practicable. This would also improve the perception of effectiveness of the FIRB.]
14. It will be especially important to identify projects with official SF requests to Research, as opposed to current Research initiatives that are primarily driven internally by Research. Research activities that are "quick burn"

8 November 2024

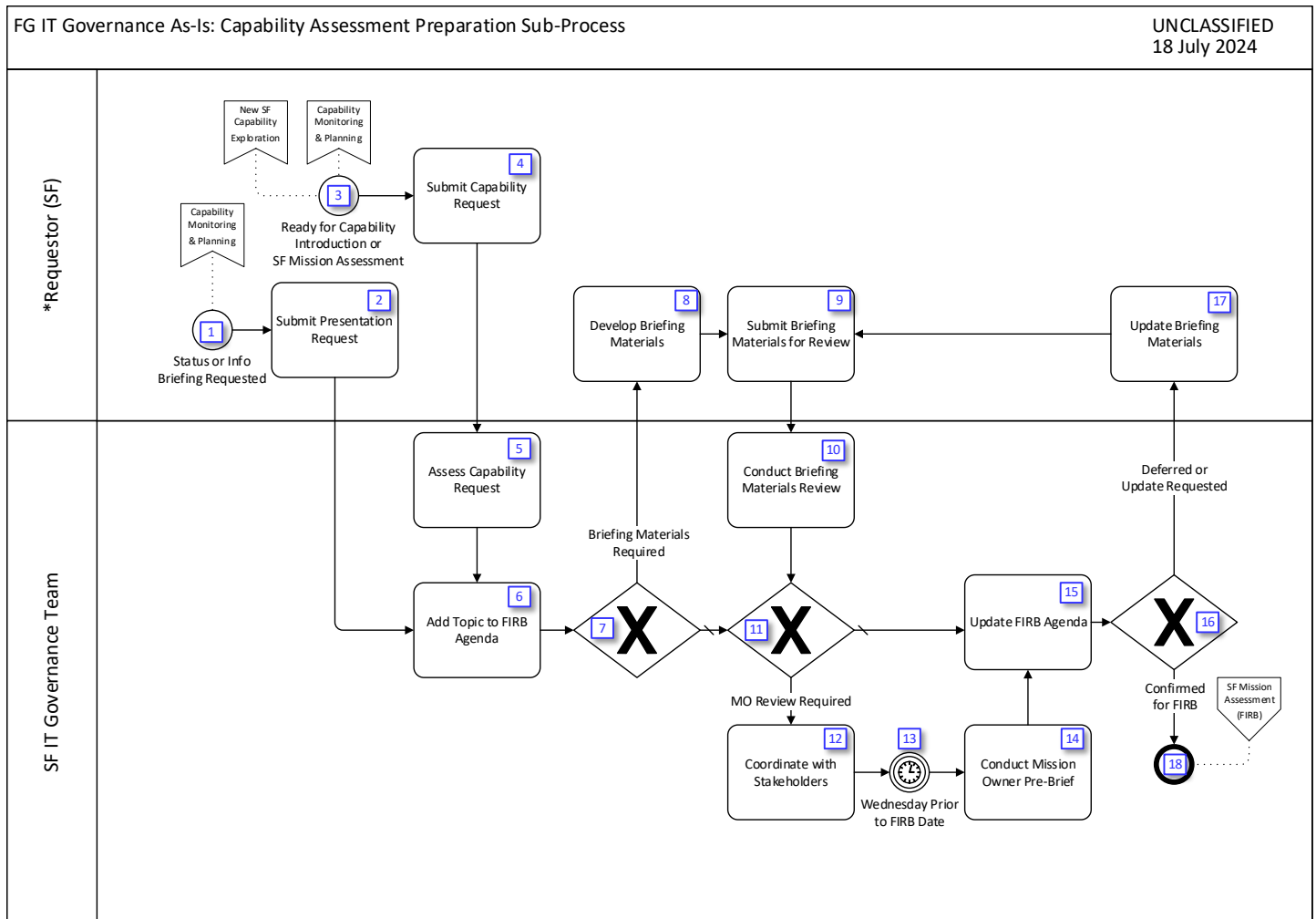
Foundation GEOINT Technology Division

FG Mission Planning [Final]

As-Is Process Models

initiatives must be balanced in light of longer (3–5 year development) activities. There is a risk that there would be minimal progress achieved against longer development activities if resources are always applied to short-duration activities. This would add balance between addressing quick burn initiatives versus longer (i.e., 3-5 year) development activities. This attempts to minimize continually delaying longer development activities in favor of addressing short-duration activities.

Appendix A: FG Capability Assessment Preparation Sub-Process Numbered Model and Definitions



FG Capability Assessment Preparation Sub-Process Model Definitions

(1) Start Event – Status or Info Briefing Requested: A status or informational briefing may be requested from any stakeholder (e.g., NGA/R, MC&G PMO, Foundation GEOINT Production Office) to inform the FIRB about progress of an existing capability or on any other topic related to FG IT to keep the FIRB stakeholders informed. This includes topics related to funding, scheduling, organizational process changes, and product quality. Most commonly, this is or an update on the development status of a capability being monitored. Other examples of status/info topics include modifications to the FG IT Capabilities baseline, routine housekeeping updates provided by the SF IT Governance Team at each FIRB, an update on a Research-developed capability, or contract/funding updates relevant to FG IT. These briefings typically do not require feedback from the board.

(2) Submit Presentation Request: The Requestor submits a presentation request to the SF IT Governance Team when ready to bring an informational briefing or status update of an existing activity to SF via the governance process. The Requestor will initiate this step based on when they expect to be ready to bring their topic to the FIRB. For example, if they would like to present to the FIRB in May, they would likely submit their request in early to mid-April. This request is less formal than a Capability Introduction or SF Mission Assessment briefing and is generally made directly to the SF IT Governance Team via phone or email. At a minimum, the request must include the name and description of the topic and the name of the SF TX sponsor for the status or informational update to the FIRB.

(3) Start Event – Ready for Capability Introduction or SF Mission Assessment: When SF has executed the New SF Capability Exploration Sub-Process and is ready to bring a topic to the larger SF audience, the Requestor (from a SF Production Office) submits a Capability Introduction request to the SF IT Governance Team. This process can also begin if a need for additional engineering support or funding is identified during the monitoring of an IT capability in development for a SF Production Office. The Requestor will generally know what type of briefing they are submitting a request for, but if they are uncertain, the SF IT Governance Team will assist them in finalizing the appropriate form of their briefing after the request is submitted.

(4) Submit Capability Request: The Requestor submits a Capability Request to the SF IT Governance Team when ready to bring a Capability Introduction or Capability Assessment to SF via the governance process. The Requestor will initiate this step based on when they expect to be ready to brief the FIRB. For example, if they would like to present to the FIRB in May, they would likely submit their request in early to mid-April. The Requestor submits the request, which must include a Summary of the topic, Process Owner, Description, and estimated time to complete, via the Jira Business Case form via the FIRB Confluence space or via an e-mail or phone call to the SF IT Governance Team requesting to be placed on the FIRB agenda. If the request was made directly to the SF IT Governance Team, the Business Case form still needs to be submitted. If this is for a capability currently being monitored by the MC&G PMO it also will require a matured Technology Transition Agreement (TTA). The Requestor is always from an FG Production Office, and the topic must have the support of the office level TX, as a Sponsor, before it proceeds.

(5) Assess Capability Request: Upon receipt of the Capability Request (i.e., Capability Introduction or Capability Assessment), the SF IT Governance Team and the Requestor coordinate to ensure that there is adequate information known about the capability to present it to the FIRB, and that the expectations of how this part of the process must function are clear. The SF IT Governance Team validates that there is a TX sponsor for the capability, identifies whether it is new or a modernization of an existing capability, determines if funding requests are involved, and asks other relevant questions to validate whether the topic should be presented as a Capability Introduction briefing or a Capability Assessment (e.g., if funding is requested it needs to be an assessment briefing, which requires a full Business Case). If this is a Research capability currently being monitored by the MC&G PMO, the SF IT Governance Team will review the TTA and confirm that it is mature enough to warrant a FIRB Capability Assessment decision. The SF IT Governance Team provides any necessary guidance to the Requestor to develop the correct materials for the FIRB (e.g., Business Case template PowerPoint charts) to ensure that adequate information will be included to provide value to SF and/or enable a Mission Owner decision (if needed). The SF IT Governance Team also confirms the feasibility of completing any required briefing materials or coordination tasks in time to meet the deadline for the upcoming FIRB date. When the request has been fully validated and confirmed for presentation to the FIRB, the Requestor is ready to complete the development of required briefing materials to enter the SF Mission Assessment Sub-Process.

(6) Add Topic to FIRB Agenda: Once the type of briefing has been determined (i.e., Information, Status, Capability Introduction or Assessment) the SF IT Governance Team updates the FIRB agenda (via Confluence) with the target date for the topic to come to the FIRB. The agenda is in the form of a list and calendar update on the FIRB Confluence space, which is available for viewing by all individuals with access to the FIRB Confluence space.

(7) Exclusive Gateway (Default / Briefing Materials Required): After confirming the topic for addition to the FIRB agenda, if development or update of briefing materials are required, the Requestor will initiate the task to generate the materials based on guidance from the SF IT Governance Team. Otherwise, the topic is ready for any stakeholder coordination required before the MO pre-brief.

(8) Develop Briefing Materials: The Requestor will develop the appropriate slide deck based on the type of briefing they are providing. This process will begin once their request has been confirmed by the SF IT Governance Team, and they have a planned date to appear at the FIRB, though often the Requestor has existing briefing materials they can tailor to meet the needs of the governance process. Status briefings or informational briefings do not have a specific template and are short, as they are typically allocated about 10 minutes on the FIRB agenda. A slide deck is not currently required for status updates; a verbal update is sometimes adequate to inform the board. Capability Introduction briefings could be in any format and will include some of the information required for a business case, such as a description of the capability, the status, a recommendation, next steps, and must include a slide presented by the TX describing the value to the production office. The Research “new start” quad chart template is very often used in an intro briefing. Capability Assessment briefings, which are requesting a decision from the Mission Owner, require the completion of the full Business Case template in PowerPoint, along with any supplemental information the TX feels is necessary to inform the stakeholders and MO. Capability Assessments and Capability Introductions are allotted 20 minutes; the Requestor should plan accordingly when developing briefing materials. The Requestor will coordinate the business case development and/or briefing materials with the SF TX and any other immediate stakeholders (e.g., Research) as necessary. The level of coordination will vary based on the direction of the SF TX for the Requestor SF Production Office.

(9) Submit Briefing Materials for Review: When the Requestor has completed the briefing materials (and coordinated with the sponsoring TX) they submit them to the SF IT Governance Team via e-mail or through the FIRB Confluence space (attached to a submitted Business Case). The Requestor must provide all briefing materials a week prior to the scheduled FIRB to ensure that the SF IT Governance Team has enough time to review, coordinate, and provide feedback on the materials that will be briefed.

(10) Conduct Briefing Materials Review: The SF IT Governance Team reviews the submitted Business Case and/or briefing materials, to ensure that all required content is provided and clearly described. The SF IT Governance Team reaches out to the Requestor if they have any questions on the purpose/intent of the briefing, to clarify the ‘ask’ if there is one, set expectations for how the FIRB is run, and answer any questions. When this review is complete, the initial briefing materials are ready to be posted to Confluence for use at the FIRB. The SF IT Governance Team meets the Tuesday prior to the scheduled monthly FIRB session to refine the agenda and confirm that all planned topics are prepared for the FIRB. The SF IT Governance Team reviews and discusses each submission with the rest of the team, identifying any potential issues or ambiguous aspects of the briefing. They also ensure that a Business Case has a clear request, such as funding or engineering support, to facilitate the Mission Owner decision at the FIRB.

8 November 2024

FG Mission Planning [Final]

Foundation GEOINT Technology Division

As-Is Process Models

(11) Exclusive Gateway (Default / MO Review Required): Materials that are ready and complete for the scheduled FIRB are first reviewed with the MO. If any rework is required or the SF IT Governance Team determines that the topic is not ready for a FIRB discussion it will be sent back to the Requestor to update the briefing materials.

(12) Coordinate with Stakeholders: The SF IT Governance Team will identify additional stakeholders that should be involved in preparing for the topic briefing at the FIRB. Gathering information and validating awareness of the upcoming briefing with key stakeholders, using the briefing materials may be required to successfully conduct the FIRB, depending on the breadth of impact of the topic. This task is complete once the SF IT Governance Team determines that the briefing has been socialized with the appropriate stakeholders.

(13) Intermediate Event (Timer) – Wednesday Prior to FIRB Date: Informal reviews of briefing materials will continue up until the Wednesday prior to the FIRB each month. On Wednesday, the SF IT Governance Team will meet with the MC&G Mission Owner for a final review of the topics/briefings.

(14) Conduct Mission Owner Pre-Brief: The SF IT Governance Team will meet with the MO to discuss any specifics of the submissions three business days prior to the scheduled FIRB and to conduct a final review of the topics/briefings. They will review the agenda and materials, and discuss any areas where improvements need to be made prior to the FIRB to ensure clarity and relevancy. For example, the MO may have additional questions to better understand the scope of the request, a desire for more information on a given topic, or feedback on the briefing charts that should be incorporated by the Requestor prior to the FIRB. The MO will confirm whether all agenda items can proceed as planned, or whether any topics need to be deferred to a future date. Once this step is finished, the team will address any outstanding topics and confirm the agenda for the upcoming FIRB with the SF IT Governance Team.

(15) Update FIRB Agenda: The Friday before the FIRB, the SF IT Governance Team updates the agenda for the appropriate FIRB on the FIRB Confluence space to reflect the upcoming briefings, whether they are status briefings, capability introductions, or new business cases for SF assessment. If the topic has been deferred, the SF IT Governance Team communicates this decision with the Requestor and asks for the briefing materials to be updated and resubmitted for a later FIRB. The SF IT Governance Team then removes it from the agenda and updates the entry in Jira (if applicable). If it was confirmed, the SF IT Governance Team validates the briefing title/topic, presenter, and date on the agenda. If minor updates to the briefing materials are required, the SF IT Governance Team communicates these changes to the Requestor, who updates the briefing materials and resubmits them prior to the FIRB date. If the topic is an Introduction or a Capability Assessment, the SF IT Governance Team also attaches the briefing materials to the business case entry in Jira and attaches the briefing materials to the Outlook meeting invite and sends it out to the FIRB stakeholders.

(16) Exclusive Gateway (Deferred or Update Requested/Confirmed for FIRB): For those briefings that have been confirmed by the MO, the process is complete for this topic, which is ready for presentation to the FIRB. If updates to the briefing materials are required prior to presenting to the FIRB, the Requestor must complete those updates and resubmit the briefing.

(17) Update Briefing Materials: Should the SF IT Governance Team reviews result in the need to update the briefing materials; the Requestor will make the necessary changes and resubmit the briefing materials. This can apply to any type of topic (e.g., status/info briefing, Capability Introduction, Capability Assessment) that is missing key information, or

8 November 2024

Foundation GEOINT Technology Division

FG Mission Planning [Final]

As-Is Process Models

needs to be modified based on pre-FIRB reviews. Once the Requestor has met the criteria communicated by the SF IT Governance Team, they will re-submit their Business Case or briefing for review.

(18) End Event – Ready for SF Mission Assessment (FIRB): Once the briefing content has been reviewed and accepted by the SF IT Governance Team, and the agenda has been updated, the topic is ready for SF review and/or Assessment at the FIRB.

Appendix B: FG Capability Assessment

Preparation Sub-Process As-Is Table View

Activity Name	Submit Presentation Request
Activity ID	2
Activity Short Description	The Requestor submits a presentation request to the SF IT Governance Team when ready to bring an informational briefing or status update of an existing activity to SF via the governance process.
Activity Inputs	Status or Info briefing need identified by SF Offices/TX, MC&G engineering, or Capability Monitoring & Planning POCs (e.g., Engagement Officers, Product Owner, etc.)
Activity Outputs	- Email message or Phone call. Must include Topic Name, Presentation Form (e.g., briefing, verbal update, etc.), Presentation Intent (e.g., awareness on an activity, update on TRB activity, etc.), Sponsor (SF TX or MO). - Email message. Confirmation that the topic will be put onto the appropriate FIRB agenda, due out for any briefing materials (if required).
Roles (*primary)	*Requestor, SF IT Governance Team
Enabling Technology	Phone, Email (MS Outlook)
Business Process Rules (optional)	Requestor will confirm that SF TX is aware of this presentation request and coordinate as needed.

Activity Name	Submit Capability Request
Activity ID	4
Activity Short Description	The Requestor submits a Capability Request to the SF IT Governance Team when ready to bring a Capability Introduction or Capability Assessment to SF via the governance process.
Activity Inputs	Capability Introduction or Assessment need identified by SF Office
Activity Outputs	- Jira entry (i.e., 'Issue') created for requested topic: - Summary - Process Owner - Description - Email message or Phone call. - Jira notifications sent to Admins, Process Owners, and submitter (Requestor) once the 'Issue' is submitted. - TTA provided (if this is an update on a capability being monitored)
Roles (*primary)	*Requestor, SF IT Governance Team (generally only phone calls/verbal requests)
Enabling Technology	Phone, Email (MS Outlook), Confluence Space, Jira
Business Process Rules (optional)	TBD
Activity Pre-Conditions	Capability Introduction, Capability Assessment Request ready to come to upcoming FIRB.

Activity Name	Assess Capability Request
Activity ID	5
Activity Short Description	Upon receipt of the Capability Request (i.e., Capability Introduction or Capability Assessment), the SF IT Governance Team and the Requestor coordinate to ensure that there is adequate information known about the capability to present it to the FIRB, and that the expectations of how this part of the process must function are clear.
Activity Inputs	• Jira notification⁸ (email) • Capability Request Information (e.g., topic, Summary, Process Owner, Description) via Jira Issue form • Or for information or status briefings, confirmation that the topic will be put onto the appropriate FIRB agenda • TTA (if this is an update on a capability being monitored)
Activity Outputs	• Validated Request (all required data complete) (within Jira) • Required business case and TTA data provided (if required) • Guidance re: Briefing Materials and process expectations (provided to Requestor, generally via email)
Roles (*primary)	*SF IT Governance Team, Requestor
Enabling Technology	Jira, Phone, Email (MS Outlook), MS PowerPoint (for templates)

Activity Name	Add Topic to FIRB Agenda
Activity ID	6
Activity Description	Once the type of briefing has been determined (i.e., Introduction or Capability Assessment) the Secretariat updates the FIRB agenda (via Confluence) with the target date for the topic to come to the FIRB. The agenda is in the form of a list and calendar update on the FIRB Confluence Space, of each topic by month. The updated agenda is available for viewing by all individuals with access to the FIRB Confluence Space.
Activity Inputs	• Request Validated
Activity Outputs	• Updated FIRB Agenda / Confluence Space
Roles (*primary)	*SF IT Governance Team
Enabling Technology	Confluence Space

⁸ Notifications are sent to individuals who are identified as Watchers. Watchers can be added by the Reporter (creator of the Business Case) or the Process Owner (person to whom the Business Case is assigned) after the Business Case is created in Jira. Watchers receive auto notifications when changes/updates are made to the Business Case.

Activity Name	Develop Briefing Materials
Activity ID	8
Activity Short Description	The Requestor will develop the appropriate slide deck based on the type of briefing they are providing.
Activity Inputs	Guidance re: Briefing Materials and process expectations
Activity Outputs	- Final Briefing Materials (.ppt) for Governance Team review - For Capability Intro briefings, the information must include: - Description of the capability - Capability status - Recommendation - Next steps - Value to the production office (presented by the TX) - For Capability Assessment briefings, the information must include: "Ask" - Background - Capability/Project Objective - Benefits & Risks - Timeline & Budget Forecast <i>Note: Above components are required for Capability Assessments; Introductions require less information, and Info/Status briefings currently have no specific template.</i>
Roles (*primary)	*Requestor, SF TX, Capability SMEs
Enabling Technology	MS PowerPoint

Activity Name	Submit Briefing Materials for Review
Activity ID	9
Activity Short Description	When the Requestor has completed the briefing materials (and coordinated with the sponsoring TX) they submit them to the SF IT Governance Team via e-mail or through the FIRB Confluence Space (attached to a submitted Business Case).
Activity Inputs	Completed briefing materials
Activity Outputs	Notification of available Briefing Materials for Review (Jira notification)
Roles (*primary)	*Requestor, SF IT Governance Team
Enabling Technology	Jira, Email (MS Outlook), MS PowerPoint
Business Process Rules (optional)	The Requestor must provide all briefing materials a week prior to the scheduled FIRB to ensure that the SF IT Governance Team has enough time to review, coordinate, and provide feedback on the materials that will be briefed.

Activity Name	Conduct Briefing Materials Review
Activity ID	10
Activity Short Description	The SF IT Governance Team reviews the submitted Business Case and/or briefing materials, to ensure that all required content is provided and clearly described.
Activity Inputs	Submitted briefing materials for review posted to Jira
Activity Outputs	- SF IT Governance Team reviewed briefing materials - Deferral request or materials are acceptable for FIRB or MO pre-brief - Potential issues or ambiguous aspects of the briefing - Clear request in Business Case
Roles (*primary)	SF IT Governance Team
Enabling Technology	Jira, Email (MS Outlook), MS PowerPoint, MS Teams

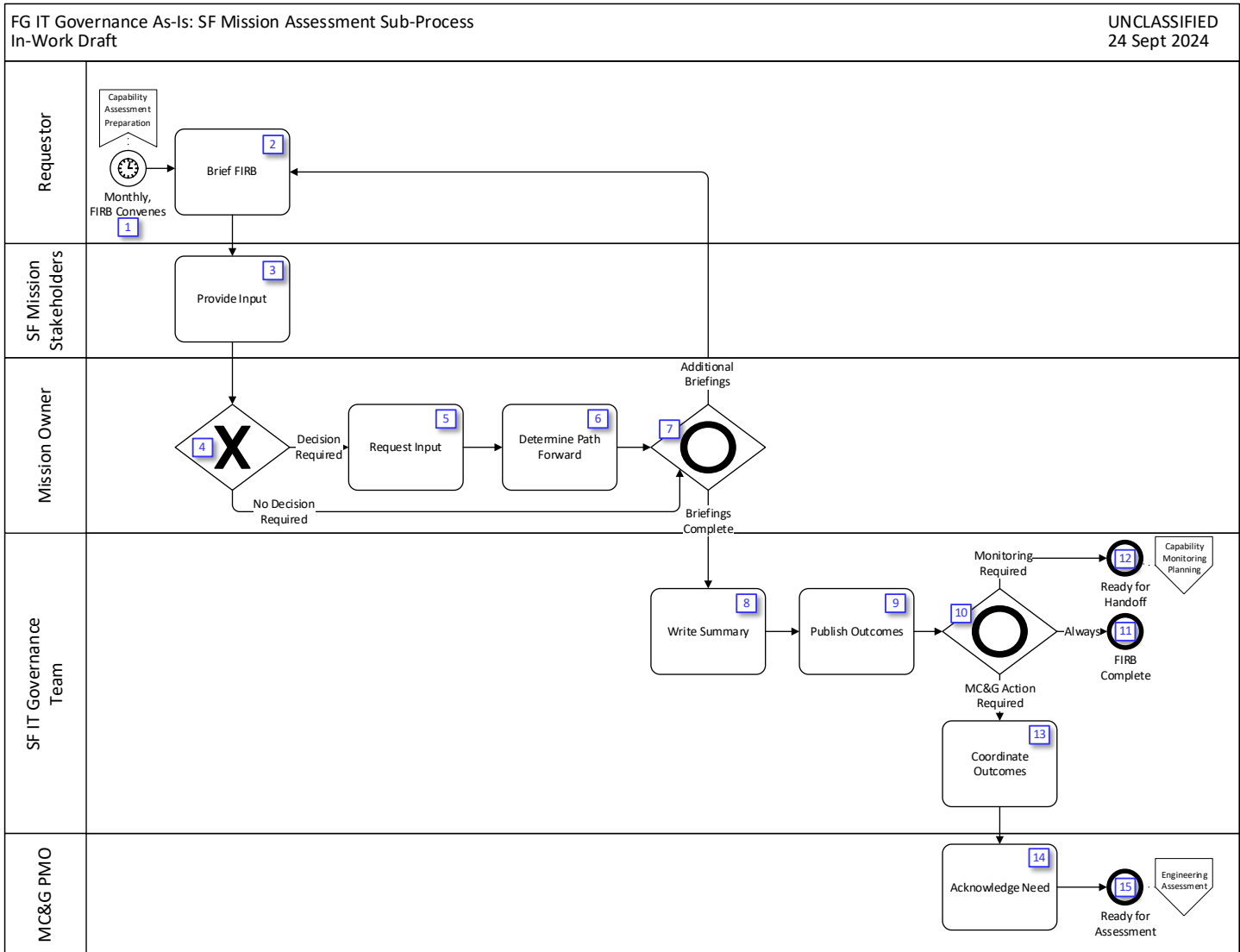
Activity Name	Coordinate with Stakeholders
Activity ID	12
Activity Description	The SF IT Governance Team will identify whether additional stakeholders should be involved in preparing for the topic briefing at the FIRB.
Activity Inputs	- Briefing materials reviewed by SF IT Governance Team that require MO pre-brief - Questions or guidance for stakeholders
Activity Outputs	- Briefing socialized with the appropriate stakeholders - Input from MC&G TRB for any request that may result in MC&G engineering assessment
Roles (*primary)	*SF IT Governance Team, Relevant Stakeholder (e.g., SF TXs, MC&G PMO, Research, ST, MC&G PMO Transition Team)
Enabling Technology	Jira, Email (MS Outlook), MS Teams, Phone

Activity Name	Conduct Mission Owner Pre-Brief
Activity ID	14
Activity Description	The SF IT Governance Team will meet with the MO to discuss any specifics of the submissions three business days prior to the scheduled FIRB.
Activity Inputs	- Briefing materials reviewed by SF IT Governance Team that require MO pre-brief - Additional information gathered from stakeholder coordination - Input from TRB coordination to discuss potential required resources, timelines, priorities, or any other topic that may be relevant to the presentation.
Activity Outputs	- NEW for Capability Introduction, Assessment, or Status Briefs: Projected IT Capabilities Baseline Alignment - Confirmed FIRB Agenda - Deferral request - Requestor feedback
Roles (*primary)	SF IT Governance Team, Mission Owner
Enabling Technology	Confluence Space, Jira, Email (MS Outlook), MS PowerPoint

Activity Name	Update FIRB Agenda
Activity ID	15
Activity Description	The Friday before the FIRB, the SF IT Governance Team updates the agenda for the appropriate FIRB on the FIRB Confluence Space to reflect the upcoming briefing, whether they are status briefings, capability introductions, or new business cases for SF assessment.
Activity Inputs	- Confirmed FIRB Agenda with MO - Deferral request - Requestor feedback
Activity Outputs	- Updated 'Upcoming FIRB topics' in Confluence Space - Updated Calendar in Confluence Space - Updated Outlook Calendar invite with agenda and final briefing materials - Updated Jira issues with attached briefing materials and/or MO decisions from pre-brief - Message to requestor to defer the briefing - Message to requestor to update briefing material and re-submit
Roles (*primary)	SF IT Governance Team
Enabling Technology	Confluence Space, Jira, Email (MS Outlook)

Activity Name	Update Briefing Materials
Activity ID	17
Activity Description	Should either of the SF IT Governance Team reviews result in the need to update the briefing materials, the Requestor will make the necessary changes and resubmit the briefing materials with updates.
Activity Inputs	- Briefing Update Required / Deferral requested - Guidance re: Briefing Materials and process expectations
Activity Outputs	Briefing Materials Ready for FIRB submission. See Develop Briefing Materials for details.
Roles (*primary)	*Requestor
Enabling Technology	MS PowerPoint

Appendix C: SF Mission Assessment Sub-Process Numbered Model and Definitions



SF Mission Assessment Sub-Process Model Definitions

(1) Start Event (Timer) – Monthly, FIRB Convenes: The sub-process begins on the first Monday of every month, when the FIRB is scheduled to convene. This 2-hour virtual forum is held at the unclassified level, and all of the topics on the agenda have been approved by the SF IT Governance Team and MC&G Mission Owner in the Capability Assessment Preparation Sub-Process. The Requestor of the first agenda item is prepared to brief one of four possible types of briefings: Capability Assessment, Capability Introduction, Information Briefing or Status Update.

(2) Brief FIRB: The Requestor presents a briefing package, which has already been reviewed and approved by the SF IT Governance Team. Each briefing has a specific purpose and may include a request for a decision from the MO. The

8 November 2024

Foundation GEOINT Technology Division

FG Mission Planning [Final]

As-Is Process Models

Requestor may be seeking funding, requesting engineering support for a new need or capability, providing an update on the development of a capability, or presenting information to provide situational awareness across SF.

(3) Provide Input: The SF Mission stakeholders in attendance at the FIRB, which include Technology Executives (TXs) from each SF Mission Production Office have the opportunity to ask questions to better understand how the topic may impact their Office. They also may opt to offer relevant insight for the benefit of SF overall or to enhance the governance process.

(4) Exclusive Gateway (Decision Required / No Decision Required): If the topic briefed is either an Information Briefing or a Status Update and no decision is required, the process bypasses the subsequent decision-related steps. If a decision or next steps are required for the topic that has just been briefed, the Mission Owner will request input as needed to make their decision.

(5) Request Input: The Mission Owner may desire additional stakeholder input prior to making a decision with respect to the topic. The MO will ask specific questions or seek other input from stakeholders, to include MC&G PMO representatives if they are in attendance. The scope of this input may be broader than that which is provided during the "Provide Input" step, which centers around the Production Office perspective.

(6) Determine Path Forward: The Mission Owner uses the input provided, as well as the SF priorities, to determine how to proceed for the decision brief presented (either a Capability Assessment or Capability Introduction). Typically, the MO will determine that additional engineering assessment via the MC&G PMO is required or that the new capability should be monitored until further progress is made.

(7) Inclusive Gateway (Additional Briefings / Briefings Complete): If there are additional topics to be briefed at this point, the process begins again with the next Requestor providing their briefing. If all agenda topics have been briefed, then the board meeting is complete, and the SF IT Governance Team begins to write the summary of the session.

(8) Write Summary: Once the meeting is adjourned, the SF IT Governance Team writes a summary to document the decisions made during the FIRB. The summary does not include details related to the briefings for which no decision or further action is required, as meeting minutes are not captured at a detailed level⁹.

(9) Publish Outcomes: The SF IT Governance Team posts the summary document and any other relevant materials to Jira to serve as a permanent record of decisions; and the briefings and meeting recording to Inteldocs for future reference.

(10) Inclusive Gateway (Monitoring Required / Always / MC&G Action Required): At this point in the process, the monthly FIRB is always complete. If additional monitoring or planning for an emerging capability is required, the SF IT Governance Team will work to stay informed as to upcoming activities related to the capability. If MC&G action is required, the SF IT Governance Team will work with the appropriate MC&G PMO PoC to coordinate the next steps.

(11) End Event – FIRB Complete: Once the outcomes of the FIRB have been published, the FIRB session activities are considered complete. For any briefing topics that did not require monitoring or action by MC&G, the SF Mission Assessment Sub-Process is complete.

⁹ Each FIRB session is recorded and made available to all stakeholders.

(12) End Event – Ready for Handoff: The capability has completed the SF Mission Assessment Sub-Process and will enter the Engineering Integration Monitoring/Planning Sub-Process.

(13) Coordinate Outcomes: If a FIRB topic is deemed to require an MC&G engineering assessment at the TRB, the SF IT Governance Team will coordinate with the appropriate MC&G PMO PoC to transition/transfer ownership and responsibility for the capability/capability need in question to them. This involves providing all associated documentation that the FIRB currently has within Jira relevant to the capability/capability need [i.e., business case, cost assessment, Concepts of Operations (CONOPs), operational views, proofs of concept, pilot or prototype materials, etc.]

(14) Acknowledge Need: The MC&G PMO PoC officially assumes responsibility for the next steps for the capability/capability need and will follow their process via the TRB to initiate an engineering assessment.

(15) End Event – Ready for Assessment: The topic is ready for the MC&G PMO to begin the engineering assessment.

Appendix D: SF Mission Assessment Sub-Process As-Is Table View

Activity Name	Brief FIRB
Activity ID	2
Activity Short Description	The Requestor presents a briefing package, which has already been reviewed and approved by the SF IT Governance Team.
Activity Inputs	- Confirmed FIRB agenda - Finalized FIRB briefing (each time a topic is briefed per session)
Activity Outputs	Information/status presented or decision requested
Roles	Requestor
Enabling Technology	MS Teams, PowerPoint, Phone

Activity Name	Provide Input
Activity ID	3
Activity Short Description	The stakeholders in attendance at the FIRB, which include TXs from SF Production Offices, offer relevant insight and/or ask questions to obtain clarification.
Activity Inputs	Information/status presented or decision requested
Activity Outputs	Additional information or insight provided
Roles	SF Mission Stakeholders
Enabling Technology	MS Teams, Phone

Activity Name	Request Input
Activity ID	5
Activity Short Description	If a decision is required, the Mission Owner may ask questions or seek other input from stakeholders in attendance.
Activity Inputs	- FIRB briefing - Stakeholder feedback
Activity Outputs	Additional information provided
Roles	Mission Owner and any stakeholders from whom the MO solicits input
Enabling Technology	MS Teams, Phone

Activity Name	Determine Path Forward
Activity ID	6
Activity Description	The Mission Owner uses the input provided, as well as the SF priorities, to determine how to proceed for the decision brief presented (either a Capability Assessment or Capability Introduction).

Activity Inputs	- FIRB Briefing - Stakeholder input - SF Priorities
Activity Outputs	Mission Owner decision/action(s)
Roles	Mission Owner
Enabling Technology	MS Teams, Phone

Activity Name	Write Summary
Activity ID	8
Activity Description	The SF IT Governance Team writes a summary to document the decisions made during the FIRB.
Activity Inputs	FIRB decisions/actions/dispositions for Capability Assessments, Capability Introductions, or Status Briefs
Activity Outputs	Word document with a summary of decisions/outcomes/actions associated with the FIRB session
Roles	SF IT Governance Team
Enabling Technology	MS Word

Activity Name	Publish Outcomes
Activity ID	9
Activity Description	The SF IT Governance Team posts the summary document to Jira; and the briefings and meeting recording to Inteldocs.
Activity Inputs	- Summary document - Recording of FIRB session
Activity Outputs	- Posted summary available to all stakeholders (Jira) - Posted recording of FIRB session (Inteldocs) - Posted FIRB session briefings (Inteldocs)
Roles	SF IT Governance Team
Enabling Technology	Jira, Inteldocs

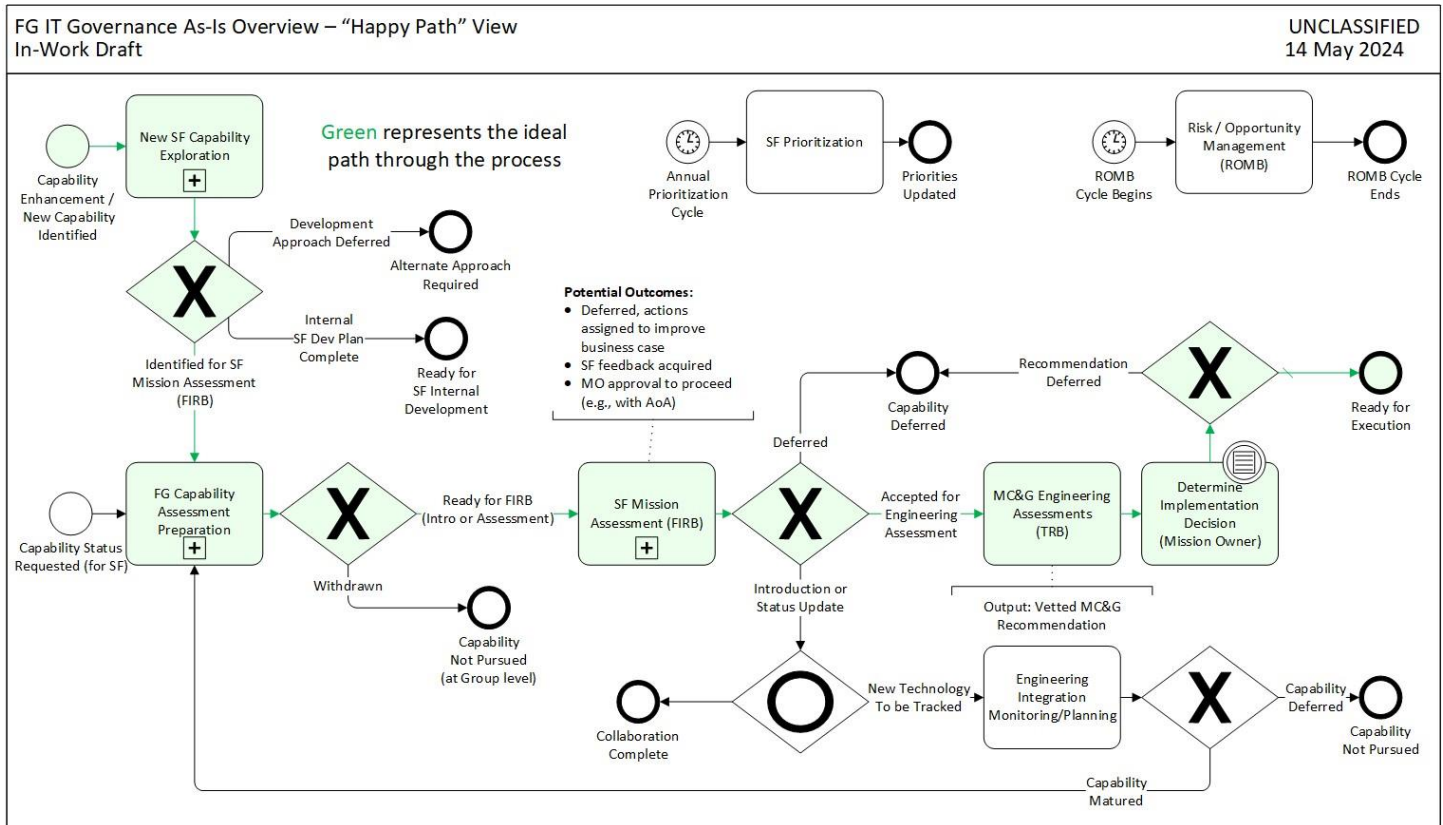
Activity Name	Coordinate Outcomes
Activity ID	13
Activity Description	The SF IT Governance Team coordinates with MC&G PMO to transition/transfer ownership and responsibility for the capability/capability need in question to them.
Activity Inputs	Mission Owner decision to perform an engineering assessment
Activity Outputs	- Business Case - Summary document
Roles	SF IT Governance Team, MC&G PMO
Enabling Technology	Email (MS Outlook), MS Teams, Phone

Activity Name	Acknowledge Need
Activity ID	14
Activity Description	The MC&G PMO PoC officially assumes responsibility for the next steps for the capability/capability need and will follow their process via the TRB to initiate an engineering assessment.
Activity Inputs	• Business Case • Summary document
Activity Outputs	Concurrence that the next steps are understood
Roles	SF IT Governance Team, MC&G PMO
Enabling Technology	Email (MS Outlook), MS Teams, Phone

Appendix E: 'Happy Path' Overview Model View

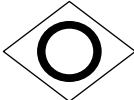
Overview Model – “Happy Path” View

The below depiction of the As-Is FG IT Governance Overview model represents the ideal path through the process, for a topic that begins as a concept within SF and proceeds all the way through the process to an implementation decision ready for execution.



Appendix F: BPMN 2.0 Legend

Below is the Business Process Model and Notation (BPMN 2.0) legend modified to include all of the symbols utilized throughout this as-is process models suite. Note that not all symbols and definitions are fully in compliance with BPMN specification and have been modified to meet the needs of NGA/SF.

FG Mission Planning 14 October 2024		FGMP Business Process Model And Notation (BPMN) Legend This legend was derived from BPMN 2.0; although not all definitions are exact. Some have been modified to meet the needs of NGA/SF.		UNCLASSIFIED BPMN Legend	
Activities: Used to represent any work performed within a business process.			Gateways: Used to represent decision points that split to multiple activities or events or that control the merging of flows to an event or activity.		
 A Task is work at the lowest level of detail that you would like to show in the process.  A Collapsed Sub-Process is an activity that has its own 'Start Event and 'End Event.' This activity is collapsed when you don't want to show the details in the current process being modeled.			 Exclusive Gateway: When splitting, it allows for only ONE of the outgoing paths to be activated. When merging, it waits for only ONE of the incoming paths before moving to the next activity or event.  Inclusive Gateway: When splitting, one or more branches are activated. When merging, it waits for ALL ACTIVE incoming branches to complete before triggering the next event/activity.		
Events			Flow Lines		
 A Start Event begins the flow of a process.  Start Event (Timer): A type of Start Event used to indicate the beginning of a process triggered by a specific time, date or cycle.  Intermediate Conditional Event: A set of distinct, repeatable business rules. The event can be attached to a task or lead into a Gateway.  Intermediate Timer Event: Acts as a delay mechanism based on a cycle, specific date-time, or time span.  End Event indicates the culmination of a process.			 A Sequence Flow defines the execution order of activities <u>WITHIN</u> a process. Each flow has only one source and only one target.  A Default Sequence Flow is the default branch to be chosen if all other outgoing flows are not valid.  An Association shows relationships between artifacts and flow objects. It is commonly used to associate off-page connectors, both incoming and outgoing to any 'Event' or 'Task.'		
Off-Page Connectors: Used to depict connectivity between models.					
 An Incoming Off-Page Reference depicts the other models that may kick off or start a given process.  An Outgoing Off-Page Reference depicts the other models that are kicked off at the end of a given process.					

Appendix G: Glossary

- **Analysis of Alternatives (AoA):** Comprehensive engineering/programmatic assessment that considers cost, schedule, and performance (including security) impacts of proposed approaches to meet an objective.
- **Business Case:** A PowerPoint presentation containing a capability description along with its scope, estimated cost, and possible funding vehicle (e.g., ROMs, WAGs, contract vehicle, etc.). Used to bring a topic to the FIRB for assessment by SF.
- **Capability:** A system, software application program or other IT entity that satisfies a mission requirement.
- **Capability Assessment:** Also called a “Business Case”, a Capability Assessment is an official presentation to the FIRB on a capability which has reached a stage where it requires a governance decision to continue moving forward in the process. Generally, the decision involves funding and/or engineering resources.
- **Capability Introduction:** Also called a “Business Case Lite”, a Capability Introduction is a less robust presentation to the FIRB on a capability, which lack details or is more notional, because it is either the product of a Research project or has not been fully developed for another reason (e.g. not mature yet).
- **DevCorps:** A division within CIO-T which has in-house software development experts, who are ready to assist with building new tools and applications. The team uses modern approaches to software development to build enterprise applications and unique mission capabilities for NGA.
- **Foundation GEOINT Information Technology Governance:** A holistic framework to streamline the coordination between SF Production Offices and the MC&G PMO to successfully identify, assess, and deliver new and emerging IT capabilities in support of the Foundation GEOINT mission.
- **Foundation GEOINT Information Technology Requirements Board (FIRB):** Functions as the “front door” for all FG IT requirements in SF (e.g., capability enhancements, new capability requests, etc.). The FIRB serves two primary purposes: 1) Vetting new and emerging IT capabilities during a public forum, validating mission requirements via proposals to Technical Executives and other leadership stakeholders across the organization; and 2) Prioritizing IT requirements to allow for better application of engineering and program management resources.
- **SF IT Governance Team** – Manages the FIRB, which includes overseeing the Capability Assessment Preparation Sub-Process and playing a key role in the SF Mission Assessment Sub-Process. These duties include, but are not limited to, capturing discussion at FIRB meetings and ensuring that all important information (e.g., FIRB agendas, deadlines, meeting records, and important documents) is available to SF stakeholders. The SF IT Governance Team also collaborates with TX Sponsors and FG Mission Owners to review and approve submitted Business Cases, ensures that all parties adhere to deadlines, and collaborates with the TRB Secretariat to ensure that meeting summaries and decisions by Mission Owners are received accurately.
- **Risk and Opportunities Management Board (ROMB):** The ROMB is responsible for tracking and managing risks and opportunities for the MC&G PMO. This board is chaired by MC&G Deputy for Programs.

- **MC&G Mission Owner (MO):** Serves as the most senior SF mission representative to the MC&G PMO. The MO is designated by the mission stakeholders and operates at the senior program leadership level. The MO serves as the voice of the SF mission and is responsible for program backlog prioritization and de-confliction; review and approval of the roadmaps and implementation plans; and works to facilitate program increment and release planning efforts. The MO works to ensure the MC&G PMO remains aligned to SF's mission needs, associated priorities, and delivers the services and capabilities that satisfy user expectations.
- **Technical Review Board (TRB):** The MC&G TRB functions as the implementation arm of the governance process, providing engineering, integration, and transition support to validate the feasibility of SF-validated requirements and develop implementation solutions.
- **Technology Transition Agreement (TTA):** An inter-organization agreement (e.g., between SF and Research, etc.), which must be finalized prior to the transition of a capability to MC&G PMO. The TTA may begin after a Capability Introduction is presented to the FIRB.
- **Transition Assessment:** An assessment the MC&G PMO conducts to identify and address the considerations around transitioning the operations and maintenance of an existing IT capability to the MC&G PMO either due to its maturity level or because it ought to be available enterprise wide.
- **TX Sponsor:** Typically, an SF Office Technical Executive (TX). They are responsible for championing a proposed IT capability in the context of the governance process. This role is identified in the first step of the New SF Capability Exploration Sub-Process, as it is a pre-requisite to the consideration of the proposed IT capability.

Appendix H: Acronym List

AI: Artificial Intelligence	PMO: Program Management Office
AoA: Analysis of Alternatives	PoC: Point of Contact
BPMN: Business Process Model and Notation	PP: Pain Point
CAC: Common Access Card	PPT: PowerPoint
CAE: Component Acquisition Executive	PMR: Program Management Review
CIO-T: Chief Information Officer & IT Services	R: Research Office
CONOP: Concepts of Operations	R&D: Research and Development
COTS: Commercial-Off-The Shelf	RFWG: Research Forum Working Group
DevCorps: See Glossary for definition	ROM: Rough Order of Magnitude, in the context of cost estimation
DNI: Director of National Intelligence	ROMB: Risk and Opportunities Management Board
FDT: Foundation Digital Twin	S: Source
FG: Foundation GEOINT	SAFe: Scaled Agile Framework
FGMP: Foundation GEOINT Mission Planning	SC: NGA Commercial Operations Group
FIRB: Foundation GEOINT Information Technology Requirements Board	SF: Foundation GEOINT Group
FOC: Full Operational Capability	SFA: Aeronautical Navigation Office
FY: Fiscal Year	SFC: Corporate Operations and Technology Office
IC: Intelligence Community	SFCA: Capabilities Integration Division
ICBD: Intelligence Capability Baseline Description	SFCAA: Technology Integration Branch
IMD: Intelligence Mission Data	SFCAB: IT Modernization and Operations Branch
IPF: Integrated Program Office – Foundation GEOINT	SFG: Office of Geography
IOC: Initial Operational Capability	SFH: Maritime Safety Office
IT: Information Technology	SFN: Office of Geomatics
LO: Liaison Officer	SGA: Senior GEOINT Authority
MC&G: Mapping, Charting, and Geodesy Services	SGO: Senior GEOINT Officer
MC&G PMO: Mapping, Charting, and Geodesy Services Program Management Office	SME: Subject Matter Expert
MO: Mission Owner	SOC: Statement of Capabilities
MS: Microsoft	SOP: Standard Operating Procedure
NGA: National Geospatial-intelligence Agency	ST: Source GEOINT Information Group
NGAI: National Geospatial-intelligence Agency Instruction	TBD: To Be Determined
O&S: Operations and Sustainment	TBN: To-Be Note
PdO: Product Owner	TRB: Technical Review Board
PEO: Program Executive Officer	TTA: Technology Transition Agreement
PM: Program Manager	TX: Technical Executive
	USG: United States Government

Appendix I: FG IT Governance As-Is Process Socialization

Inputs from Research Group and SFN Engagements – Spring 2024

R & SFN Pain Points

1. Multiple SF and Research stakeholders are concerned about the delay and lack of action and/or awareness of status that occurs after providing a Capability Introduction (via the SF Mission Assessment process). Support for tracking the capability through the rest of the governance process and providing routine status would help avoid unnecessary delays or miscommunications on when certain actions should be taken (e.g., return to the FIRB for a status update, engineering request, etc.). Additionally, regular updates may uncover opportunities for collaboration across the organization if there are similar needs and/or requirements across production offices and may help facilitate planning and integration of capabilities for the benefit of SF as a whole. See related To-Be Note #13.
2. MC&G's program build does not include Research and Development (R&D) planned transitions and hasn't for the last several years. None of R&D's FY26 transitions were included in MC&G's FY26 program build, even though components of the program build are aligned with FG strategic documents such as the Statement of Capabilities (SOC) and the Intelligence Capability Baseline Description (ICBD) and were brought to the FIRB by SF sponsors. Ideally, the future governance process should influence the program build and have contingencies in place regardless of the outcome of the program build to support transition of key capabilities. Utilization of the NGA/R Technology Transition Agreement (TTA) could be a piece of this future process. See related To-Be Notes #1 and #2.
3. Research does not have clear guidance from SF on the IT capability needs that would help them meet their high-priority requirements. Additionally, the drivers [i.e., priorities, hard problems lists, Statement of Capabilities (SOC)/Independent Cost Baseline Document (ICBD)] are not clearly aligned across different efforts, adding complexity to the process of determining which IT capabilities are the true high-value needs that should be focus areas for development. Currently, Research performs a significant amount of outreach and research to solicit needs and evaluate the potential for successful integration into the operational baseline, but these needs should ideally be flowed to Research from mission areas (e.g., SF) in a more uniform, consistent manner. Recently Research has been focused on the GEOINT hard problems, which were developed but not widely disseminated by NGA leadership. They also received a set of Geodesy hard problems during a meeting with the Office of Geomatics (SFN); however, they do not align with the GEOINT hard problems, and it was unknown how they align with SFN and/or SF priorities. In addition, the SOC/ICBD effort provides a large amount of information on capability needs; however, potential solutions are not always clearly defined; alignment with SF priorities is sometimes lacking, and there is no alignment with the GEOINT hard problems. Without an integrated and complete set of priorities to guide Research, potential opportunities to achieve efficiency are missed. See related To-Be notes #3-#5.

4. There is not a formal connection between the official SF prioritization process and the FG IT Governance process. Development of SF priorities occurs too late for Research to plan for and allocate funding and is not always coordinated with other priority inputs (e.g., 'hard problems' lists), which prevents Research from effectively planning for the development of new capabilities to meet high-priority SF requirements. See related To-Be notes #3-#5.
5. There is currently a lack of transparency or visibility associated with the process to secure funds to transition a capability to sustainment; in particular, the origin of the funds and whether they will in fact be secured at a later date, if applicable. Moreover, once a capability is approved by the engineering team, the cost estimate may go to the SF Production Office, but there are no further updates regarding the commitment of funds. There is also confusion regarding what happens to a capability if MC&G has to prioritize a new capability over something already in work. This lack of clarity often leads to confusion and delays in transitioning a capability to operations and/or sustainment. The process to secure funds to transition a capability to sustainment, to include next steps when an attempt to secure funding hits a wall, needs to be more clearly defined and communicated. Without more clarity and transparency in the acquisition of transition funding, there is continued risk for capability delays or failure to implement capabilities altogether. These issues also negatively impact buy-in for the FG IT Governance processes and introduce uncertainty to resource and program planning. See related To-Be notes #3-#5.
6. There are multiple issues associated with how and by whom the capability prioritization process is executed today. Some of the concern is simply lack of awareness around how decisions are made with respect to each office's top priorities. A single source for SF priorities is needed in order to consistently make appropriate decisions on which FG IT capability needs should be explored, funded, and developed. Without a streamlined, well-socialized prioritization process, frustration with unexpected funding decisions will continue, and SF Offices will be more limited in their ability to plan alternatives or mitigation strategies for capabilities falling below the line for development and funding by the MC&G PMO. See related To-Be notes #3-#6.

R & SFN To-Be Notes

General

1. The SF IT Governance Team would like to develop a stronger understanding of the Research TTA process. The team would like to work with Research to decompose the TTA process into functions to identify which components are valuable to the governance process in general, and to identify gaps in the as-is TTA process to be addressed by the To-Be process. As part of this exploration, the governance team would like to engage with the SF TXs to identify which, if any, processes they currently have within their offices to monitor and track potential capabilities in development, which could be integrated into the governance process, and evaluate which aspects of the TTA process could be replicated to monitor capabilities developed outside of Research. *Note: Recommendation from R is to start with EGM-TNG and Magneto, section 1 completed in Nov 2023.*
2. The SF IT Governance Team should work with Research to discuss the process for including entities in the MC&G program build and explore how the governance process could be adjusted to better account for transition of Research programs. Specifically, clarifying why these programs were omitted from the FY26 program build would be helpful. Additionally, Research would like to collaborate on ideas to utilize the FG IT Governance process to reduce

8 November 2024

Foundation GEOINT Technology Division

FG Mission Planning [Final]

As-Is Process Models

risk regarding the outcome of the program build process, either by influencing the program build itself, or by establishing mitigation plans to address programs that are omitted.

FG IT Priorities

3. The SF IT Governance Team needs to identify, and make available, the official Foundation GEOINT Group priorities. Additionally, the team should identify the parties responsible for managing and approving this list, as well as establishing the needed roles and processes if they do not currently exist. Understanding the SF priorities and “hard problems” further in advance would enable Research to develop a more informed portfolio of planned activities to support SF needs and would help Research balance a variety of capability developments in terms of priority, size, and other variables (e.g., cost, complexity, and execution timelines).
4. The SF IT Governance Team should explore and (if necessary) define the essential connection between the SF Prioritization process and the current FG IT Governance process. Currently, most new capabilities/enhancements originate in Research, or within the SF Offices and are unrelated to the highest SF priorities. Research seeks out guidance from other sources such as the Agency Hard Problems list or individual SF Production Office’s needs (e.g., Geodesy Hard Problems). Formalizing a connection between the official SF prioritization process and providing an earlier and wider distribution of the SF priorities will enable Research to more effectively plan for development of new capabilities to meet high-priority SF requirements.
5. The SF Prioritization process (i.e., 1-n list) should consider incorporating the ability to identify which capabilities should be developed by Research, DevCorps, or even collaboratively between the two groups. This could be a step towards identifying intended allocation of capability development up front in the process and would incorporate additional transparency in process execution.
6. As part of further developing the SF Prioritization process, the SF IT Governance Team should continue to explore the role of the SF TX in the development of the SF prioritization framework, as well as the potential for groups (e.g., Research) to collaborate directly with MC&G MO to plan and prioritize specific activities. Earlier involvement of a broader set of SF stakeholders in the prioritization process could help as well as add transparency with respect to prioritization decisions.

Capability Enhancement/New Capability Exploration

7. SF IT Governance Team and Research leadership should hold discussions to evaluate the cadence of the monthly Research Forum Working Group (RFGW) sessions and assess whether they should be held on a different cadence or on an ad-hoc basis. The relationship, communications, and processes between Research, SF, and the MC&G PMO have matured significantly, potentially surpassing the need for recurring monthly Working Group sessions and Quarterly Forums. The Working Group sessions have fostered dynamic, ad-hoc engagements to occur as needed. Research PMRs are now open to all stakeholders for updates and tracking purposes; SF and the MC&G PMO receive updates on all Research programs projected to transition to the MC&G PMO. Continued, routine coordination between Research and SF through SFC should inform as to the best time and venue for a working group discussion to ensure efficient utilization of limited resources.
8. To help facilitate the discussions on the future of the RFGW, the SF IT Governance Team should define the process functions accomplished by the Research Forum Working Group, in order to capture those related to FG IT Governance (particularly those which are part of the Capability Exploration Sub-Process). The RFGW itself is not a

8 November 2024

Foundation GEOINT Technology Division

FG Mission Planning [Final]

As-Is Process Models

governance body, but it is a forum that helps to inform/drive capability exploration and should therefore be better understood to ensure that the essential functions of the RFWG required as interactions with the governance process are properly captured.

SF Mission Assessment (FIRB)

9. Several improvements to the logistics of the FIRB and communication of FG IT needs and capability status should be considered based on feedback gathered from multiple stakeholder groups. To assist with stakeholder notification, preparation, and action after the review board the following improvements should be implemented:
 - a. Publicize the deadline for submission (e.g., six business days prior to the FIRB).
 - b. Publicize the final agenda and required attendees at least three business days prior to the FIRB.
 - c. Make available the presentation and discussion materials to all stakeholders prior to the start of the FIRB. This will assist those that want to review the material prior to the presentation and/or reference the materials on their own during the FIRB.
 - d. Ensure that all current and historical materials are easy to discover and readily available.
 - e. Provide the link to the location of current and historical FIRB materials (e.g., FIRB Confluence Space) each time a communication (e.g., FIRB meeting invite) is sent related to the FIRB.
10. The SF IT Governance Team should further define the differences between the three types of topics that enter the SF Mission Assessment process (via the FIRB). Providing discrete guidance on when and how an Introduction, Assessment, and Status update need to come to the FIRB, as well as their respective paths through the rest of the process, would provide needed guidance to stakeholders, and potentially identify opportunities to address some functions in different ways (e.g., via separate meetings).
11. The SF IT Governance Team should draft and disseminate a list of the benefits of adhering to the FG IT Governance processes to increase support, advocacy, participation and enthusiasm across the stakeholders and leader groups, in response to GEOINT Mission Managers' and SGAs' desire to cultivate authority and championing of capabilities/efforts.
12. To aid in communicating the status of prior FIRB topics to all stakeholders, the SF IT Governance Team should provide a recap and update on prior decisions made by the FIRB/MO as well as a future prediction of what is up next for FIRB/MO introductions or decisions. This information should become a staple segment at the beginning or end of the FIRB to help with stakeholder perceptions and concerns that previous topics are not continuing to move through the process. Providing a status for all needs or capabilities that have come through the FIRB and still require action would ensure that all stakeholders understand where their capability need is within the process and would eliminate the perception that it is no longer being monitored within the governance process. Clearly aligning the various decisions/topics to the stakeholder organizations could also be beneficial to allow for stakeholders to quickly discover the topics of greatest interest to them. The ability to show and measure the capabilities that successfully made it through the entire process and are being integrated or sustained by the MC&G PMO should also be considered. This information would be beneficial for assessing how well the governance process is working, identifying areas of improvement, and highlighting for all stakeholders the success of the process.

8 November 2024

FG Mission Planning [Final]

Foundation GEOINT Technology Division

As-Is Process Models

Capability Monitoring & Planning

13. The SF IT Governance Team should work closely with SMEs, particularly Research, on further expanding the Capability Monitoring & Planning Sub-Process. Research endorses the documentation of capability monitoring and planning as a part of the governance process, because it aims to ensure that capabilities return to the FIRB at the right time and help to keep progress moving forward. This work should include considering the possibility of identifying whether a capability should be monitored or not and by whom, as a FIRB outcome.
14. The SF IT Governance Team should work with the MC&G MO and the MC&G PMO to assess the cost and benefits of assigning an MC&G Project Manager to monitor new capabilities that have been determined at the FIRB to have enough potential to support an SF priority. If the MC&G PMO is able to support this work, the specific monitoring duties and methodology need to be defined. For example, for Research capabilities, a TTA may be used, and the PM would be responsible for drafting sections two and three of the TTA artifact as the capability proceeds through the process. This role would also include monitoring the maturity of the capability, engaging in transition planning in partnership with capability provider, and briefing updates to required stakeholders (e.g., FIRB, Chief Acquisition Authority (CAE), etc.). Research recommends that the PM attend capability developer (i.e., Research, DevCorps) PMRs, and be invited to MC&G, PEO and CAE PMRs.
15. The SF IT Governance Team and the MC&G PMO engineering teams should collaborate to define a more transparent, comprehensive (i.e., end-to-end) solution for managing transition of capabilities to the MC&G PMO for integration and/or sustainment. It is currently a difficult undertaking to transition Research-developed capabilities from Research to the intended user base/office/mission area; refinement to the process to identify the specific parties accountable for each step in the process would enhance FG IT Governance as a whole.

R& SFN Additional inputs:

This is outside the scope of the current governance process improvement effort but is recorded here for potential future action.

1. The SOC gaps list needs to be inclusive of all of the NGA gaps/hard problems. Furthermore, issues sometimes remain on the SOC gaps list of several years without being addressed, so there is a need to incorporate a process to monitor that issues are reviewed on a standard interval.

SFH Pain Points

1. The current FG IT Governance process is not focused on requirements. Instead, it is focused on implementation and sustainment of existing IT capabilities, without a trace back to the Foundation GEOINT products that they support. The MC&G PMO is currently structured based on IT contracts and tracks via systems, whereas the production offices are data/product focused. The MC&G PMO has recently announced a restructure; however, without careful consideration of the alignment with the requirements process and an effective governance process, it may continue to be largely ineffective in terms of supporting FG production.
2. The FIRB process is currently inadequate to support the requirements process. For example, the Maritime requirement to migrate from the S-57 format to the S-101 is a huge problem to solve that encompasses all phases of mission execution and will impact multiple existing systems and require new capabilities. This cannot be presented in the current 5 chart FIRB business case template. A lot of effort is put in to developing Solution Epics to capture production office needs; however, this does not seem to be tied to the FG IT Governance Process and the capability needs are merely provided to an MC&G PMO engineer to “figure it out.” Without a

relationship between the governance process and the existing requirements efforts (e.g., Solution Epics), the governance process will struggle to support the development of these capabilities. See related To-Be Notes #7 & #8.

3. The current governance process reflects a mixture of the new Scaled Agile Framework (SAFe) and the traditional “Systems Engineering V” Model. The role of the architecture team, as well as when and where cost and integration planning take place within the process is not well defined. With this combination of methodologies there are major gaps in the planning for and tracking/accountability of both requirements and IT capabilities.
4. It is unclear which topics, and at what point in their lifecycle, they need to be brought to the FIRB. The SF IT Governance Team needs to define the criteria for when a topic requires FIRB/MO approval (e.g., Do all new capability needs come to the FIRB? Does every business case that costs money require a FIRB briefing? Do potential cost savings efforts require FIRB/MO approval? Often work can be done on existing contracts to build or enhance capabilities. What are the criteria for bringing these types of efforts to the FIRB?) See related To-Be Note 10a.
5. The existing process does not assist the Production Offices in getting the solutions they need into operations. The FIRB often acts as a roadblock, requiring more work for the Production Offices to answer questions about their requirement instead of validating the requirement to progress with solution development and/or integration into operations.
 - a. The path to operations is unclear, and this is impacting the success of implementing new capabilities required to meet the FG mission. The readiness process once had a clearly defined Initial Operational Capability (IOC) and Full Operational Capability (FOC); however, the meaning of these states within the acquisition process has become muddled.
6. Currently there is not a trace between the systems and services the MC&G PMO manages and the products that are produced by the SF Production Offices. The Production Offices track mission success based on data and product coverage, while the PMO tracks by systems. Production of data and products is the core mission of the Production Office, and without a direct tie to those, the FG IT Governance process is at risk of being ineffective. MC&G struggles to manage duplicative efforts, because each Office tailors their architecture, solutions, software, contracts to their own requirements. Managing the trace between products and enabling systems/services will increase efficiencies that will reduce costs & duplications. See related TBN #3 and #4.
7. There are not enough engineers within the MC&G PMO to support all the engineering needs of the Production Offices. These engineers are critical to identifying a complete solution to the established requirements, putting together a cost estimate, and determining an integration plan for new capabilities in development. The engineers are often siloed by the mission execution phase (e.g., get it, make it, manage it, share it), which is not ideal for all engineering activities. The appropriate volume (and organizational structure) of MC&G PMO engineering support needs to align with the needs of SF or else critical engineering support will not be available to inform capability development.

1. SF and the MC&G PMO should continue to consider the way the MC&G PMO is organized, and how that impacts the ability to execute against FG IT needs. The shift to PEOs may provide a good opportunity to re-evaluate having a single PM oversee each SF Production Office. The Production Offices produce a variety of data and products and have many complex processes and IT needs. It takes a significant amount of time to fully understand each mission area, and this understanding directly contributes to the success of IT solutions to support the mission. The number of reviews and approvals by different leaders within the organization required for an IT solution to proceed to the sustainment phase should be minimized.
2. The MC&G PMO should continue to explore how the FG architecture can provide the most value to FG IT Governance. The architecture could provide a view of individual services and how they are integrated and utilized across SF to meet the mission. If MC&G PMs could focus more time to understand the Offices' future product transitions, then MC&G PMs could better align the Offices' requirements to MC&G's standard architectures & solutions.
3. The MC&G PMO should consider further defining the common architecture to capture individual services. If the architecture depicted more detailed information about these services, the PMO should consider what it would take to manage the IT baseline at the services level. MC&G may be able to provide more cost-efficient solutions by aligning to standard architectures and managing at the services level (e.g., via Solution Epics) rather than at the system level. FG mission diversity and variety of system architectures make bringing all of SF onto a common architecture at the system level incredibly complex.
4. The MC&G PMO should more clearly define the hierarchy for IT governance. This should include a direct traceability between the services and the FG data/products they support, which are defined in the Intelligence Mission Data (IMD) Plan. Using this information, Engineers will need to understand & try to align each Office's requirements (including schedules and budgets) to the MC&G architecture to more effectively develop capabilities using "common" services. This mapping will also facilitate more effective enterprise engineering and integration activities, and more easily identify opportunities for cost savings (e.g., if a product is retired, all associated services, such as dissemination services, could be scaled back or potentially retired as well). It would also facilitate decision-making when a product is sunset, since the related enterprise services could also be retired (or scaled differently).
5. The MC&G PMO should determine which type of systems engineering method should be utilized (e.g., SAFe, traditional Systems Engineering V, etc.); communicate that clearly to all stakeholders; and identify the changes to the FG IT Governance process required to support it. This will help all parties better understand their roles in developing and implementing a capability. For example, MG&G PMO engineers need to understand the engineering and architecture efforts required to assist a production office.
6. The SF IT Governance Team should further analyze how to support the integration & engineering needs of the production offices, and specifically determine if this handoff is something that should be an official part of the governance process. The SF IT Governance Team should not have to manage engineering; however, the SF leadership team needs to identify the appropriate individual/role to perform this function. SF needs to ensure that the Production Offices have the engineering support they need for the funded high-priority capabilities to

ensure that the proper engineering and integration tasks can be completed in a timely fashion. Related to TBN #3 Capability Preparation Sub-Process.

7. The SF IT Governance Team should pursue the formal use of established FG Solution Epics (SEs) to structure the FG IT Governance process and improve the relevance of the FIRB to the broader requirements process. Ideally, when a topic comes to the FIRB, the appropriate SE should already be identified, and the capability in question should address a specific aspect of the SE. Further discussion should explore the benefit of addressing potential solutions at the function level (Minimum Viable Product functions (MVPf)) as part of the preparation to bring a topic or concept to the FIRB for discussion. In addition to reducing the number of topics coming to the FIRB seemingly 'out of the blue', this approach would leverage the existing requirements engineering process to depict how a proposed capability fits with the overarching goals of the solution architecture.
8. In conjunction with To-Be Note #7, the SF IT Governance Team should develop a process to connect capabilities that are NOT related to an existing SE in the existing requirements process. Discussion should include validating that capabilities that do not align to an existing SE should have a process for funding/implementation (e.g., if they are vetted by the FIRB and deemed to be high priority enough for further pursuit). These discussions should involve working with FG PMs to identify the lead time required to update an SE for the next POM cycle, in order to establish a clear schedule for the funding of new capabilities in line with the requirements process. Establishing this process will further enhance the value of the FIRB, as it will socialize and approve new capabilities and concepts for inclusion in the overarching FG Solution Architecture. Additionally, this enhanced governance process would provide a means to initiate updates to (or creation of new) Solution Epics for the appropriate PMs to manage these capabilities through the requirements process.
9. The SF IT Governance Team should consider leveraging a use case (such as the Bathy self-service topic that recently came to the FIRB) to expand the FG IT Governance process for the future.
10. See items #2, #5, #7 from the Capability Prep TBN – these all apply to Maritime PP.
 - a. (2) SFC should work with SF to identify a high-level set of business rules governing which topics are presented to the FIRB, based on anticipated value. The primary goal would be to establish clear criteria for when topics are **required** to come to the FIRB, as well as criteria for optional topics. Value to the SF mission should be addressed as part of these discussions (e.g., avoiding future development delays, establishing a record of concurrence of a mission need across SF, acquiring MC&G PMO support for a needed engineering study, potential integration across production offices, etc.).
 - b. (5) In the near-term, SFC would like to build out a semi-automated workflow management capability utilizing their JIRA site to improve communication and efficiency in managing the FIRB. Potential topics for inclusion:
 - i. Provide status/dashboard for FIRB topics (e.g., Capability Introduction Complete, etc.) and allow for enabling the use of categories in a project tracker type view.
 - ii. Enable a capability whereby the data associated with the Business Case would be submitted directly via the FIRB Jira instance, to trigger the appropriate workflow status.
 - iii. Identify additional opportunities for increased efficiency (e.g., providing a notification to SF TX teams when pre-reads are posted to Jira).

- iv. Integrate Jira workflows of the FIRB and TRB to facilitate more efficient and complete collaboration between SF and the MC&G PMO regarding IT capabilities.
- b. (7) Develop the process for FG IT Governance leadership to track progress/status of a capability after a decision is made, and the capability moves to implementation. This information would be valuable as a status update for SF and would enable the appropriate audience (e.g., FIRB) to address significant developments that may come up during project execution. There is currently no formal means to track a capability end-to-end from initial identification to implementation, and this would ensure that appropriate topics remain “on the radar” until deemed complete.
 - i. Potential flow: FG IT Governance leadership will reach out periodically to determine whether there is enough movement to provide an update to SF. The process may vary depending on whether the project has recently reached a milestone.

SFA & SFG Pain Points

1. FG Production offices sometimes propose introductions to the FIRB for capabilities that they are developing on their own with limited MC&G PMO engagement (e.g., Maritime Safety Office (SFH) Bathymetric Self Service). Lack of consistent insight into the status of these capabilities after they come to the FIRB (e.g., managed by MC&G, targeted for transition to MC&G) reduces the potential value the governance process could provide.
2. Critical communication from MC&G related to software changes must be provided further in advance to minimize reactive activities to perform software fixes (i.e., Adobe, ArcMap to ArcPro transition). The lack of dependable, timely communication on software requirements, leaves production offices at a disadvantage, often having to scramble at the last minute to implement changes and try to minimize impacts to the mission. See related To-Be Note #5.
3. The level of effort to bring a capability through the process, particularly in regards to the transition of IT capabilities from the Aeronautical Navigation Office (SFA) to the MC&G PMO, can be challenging and difficult to navigate. SFA has always managed its own requirements and has historically been successful. The future FG IT Governance process must not introduce overly cumbersome hurdles for SF, who would like to streamline this process of transitioning capabilities without impacts to operations.
4. The IT Portfolio is not currently well diversified. SF missions would be better served with more options of vendors and contractors. Additionally, it is a challenge to understand which capabilities are managed by MC&G, and which are not – transparency into this status (e.g., binning of all capabilities into appropriate categories) is lacking. See related To-Be Note #7.
5. SF needs a process for funding, implementation, and management of smaller tools (bigger tools we can go through research, etc.), as procuring these tools within the SF organization is not permitted. It is important to take into account the fact that there is no clear process for how SF engages the NGA Commercial Operations Group (SC) for a commercial capability. Currently the offices are responsible for figuring out how to address these smaller tools/capabilities on their own, making this much more challenging than it would be if a standard process existed.
6. The current process routes all key decisions to the MC&G Mission Owner rather than being shared across multiple stakeholders or leadership members. Additionally, the priorities framework that should ideally feed

MC&G Mission Owner decisions is not integrated into the governance process. This approach places significant responsibility on a single individual for decision-making, and does not adequately allow for stakeholder (e.g., FG TX) input, which could lead to conflicts over allocation of funds to one Production Office over another.

SFA & SFG To-Be Notes

1. The SF IT Governance Team should work with the SF Production offices to discuss how SF can best utilize the governance process to secure funding for, implement, and manage smaller tools and capabilities that generally would not be developed by Research. The current process may require changes, or potentially establishing a separate process thread to more effectively and rapidly address these smaller capabilities, which could include commercially available solutions (see related To-Be Note #4).
2. The SF IT Governance Team should consider working with the Office of Geography (SFG) to explore the development of a process for SFG to purchase, implement, and transition Commercial Off The Shelf (COTS) tools to meet capability needs that are not currently available nor in development elsewhere across the enterprise. Incorporating a process to address COTS capabilities, as well as working with SC to develop commercial capabilities, would broaden the FG IT governance process to more explicitly include the commercial use case, and enable easier utilization of commercial development capabilities that meet cost and performance needs.
3. The FIRB would potentially be an effective means to address capability needs that span across multiple SF mission areas (e.g., FG Dissemination), given the participation in the process by all the SF offices. In the current process, the SF Mission Assessment step (i.e., FIRB) generally focuses on what each FG office requests (e.g., funds and/or engineering support) to support their piece of the FG mission. SF TXs do believe that this is a helpful function, as it helps them better understand what potential solutions are being assessed for other production offices, though the assembled SF TX team could also be leveraged to address more activities that impact multiple production offices, which has not been very common. The SF IT Governance Team should work with the MC&G Mission Owner and SF TXs to establish a list of the most important topics (e.g., specific capabilities required to support FG Dissemination, Foundation Digital Twin, etc.) that span across the SF mission and identify the appropriate way to effectively address them within the FG IT governance process. Additionally, the SF IT Governance Team should consider shifting some of the focus away from individual technology proposals. Instead, they should establish a set of processes to help identify needs/capabilities (instead of solutions) and bring more of these through the SF Mission Assessment process to leverage cross-cutting opportunities to develop solutions that benefit SF as a whole. Any adjustments to the overall function of the FIRB should preserve the current value of elevating awareness across SF of what each office is doing, in order to identify opportunities for re-use, to minimize potential conflicts, and enhance information sharing. See related To-Be Note #4.
4. SF TX participation in the FIRB is beneficial from a situational awareness perspective, but in the future, the role of the SF TX team at the FIRB should be re-assessed to further increase the value of their involvement. While there is an opportunity for the TXs to speak at the FIRB on a given topic, this is not a formal part of the process (i.e., they are not directly asked for their opinions on every decision). Additionally, the topics coming to the FIRB today primarily address the needs of a single production office, and other TXs would have minimal weigh-in regarding these topics.

5. The SF IT Governance Team should evaluate the current process for identifying and communicating software changes that impact SF (e.g., upgrade to ArcPro), and establish a solution to notify SF at an earlier date of any changes, in order to avoid last-minute scrambles to meet these software requirements. A means for consistent, clear communication of software baseline changes (e.g., a calendar of target dates for each change) should be considered. Improvements in this area would render a better outcome for SF and reduce lost time or potential impacts to mission based on addressing these software changes as 'quick turn', urgent activities.
6. The SF IT Governance Team needs a better understanding of how individual FG Production offices across SF engage with Research and the MC&G PMO today, in order to gather more ideas and lessons learned on how to streamline this process. The team should engage with production offices to identify this information to inform future updates to the FG IT Governance process.
7. The SF IT Governance Team and the MC&G PMO should hold further discussions with the FG Production Offices to identify whether the recent re-org, which intended to better consolidate each mission set (i.e., Air, Land, etc.) and clearly document which entity is managing each capability within their IT Portfolio. Ideally, these updates to the org should contribute to better communication of responsibility for different capabilities and facilitate elevation of areas where the portfolio needs diversification to provide more options to the Production Offices to meet their needs. See related Pain Point #4.